ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR OFFICE COORDINATION AND ADMINISTRATIVE SUPPORT

Office & Administration English

Clear arrangements. Reliable follow-through.



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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 Scheduling across calendars and time zones, page 4

Clarify a missing time reference and read back two equivalent local times before issuing a meeting invitation.

02 Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages, page 14

Route a caller by purpose, capture the reference and preferred reply route, and relay a requested deadline without guaranteeing it.

03 Preparing meetings and confirming action points, page 26

Use the final minutes of a meeting to confirm an action owner, deliverable, deadline, and deferred agenda item.

04 Checking document versions and access, page 36

Correct an outdated document message and request appropriate viewing access without independently widening the audience.

05 Querying office supplies and delivery differences, page 48

Present a documented quantity discrepancy and request the missing supply information without inventing a cause or approving payment.

06 Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements, page 58

Welcome a visitor, distinguish two possible hosts, and explain the waiting arrangement while preserving the actual access boundary.

07 Clarifying travel options and booking status, page 70

Compare two supplied rail quotes, explain the conditional refund amount, and distinguish a comparison from an approved booking.

08 Prioritizing work and handing over coverage, page 81

Explain a capacity conflict with concrete timings and ask the manager to select a priority or change a deadline.

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Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Make the arrangement explicit.

Administrative work connects people who hold different pieces of information. A useful message identifies the relevant person or record, separates a request from a promise, and makes the next action easy to understand.

Name the reference

A first name, clock time, or filename may not identify the intended person, moment, or document. Confirm the distinguishing detail before sending an invitation, directing a visitor, or circulating a correction.
"Do you mean 3:00 in your office, which is noon in the other office on this date?"

Keep requests and commitments distinct

A caller can request a deadline without the recipient agreeing to it. A manager can request an extra task without creating extra time. Preserve the request and ask for the missing confirmation or priority decision.
"Lena requests a callback before 4:00; availability has not been confirmed."

Separate preparation from approval

Obtaining quotations is not buying a printer. Comparing fares is not booking travel. A useful action record names the owner, deliverable, and due date without quietly adding spending authority.
"Sam will obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase is approved."

Correct the message without expanding authority

Replace outdated information clearly and identify the current source. An access problem should go to the document owner rather than prompting an unauthorized wider share. Courteous reception likewise preserves the actual visitor arrangements.
"Use approved version 3. I will ask the owner to resolve your viewing access."

Professional boundaries

All organizations, records, prices, schedules, and policies are fictional. Use actual workplace approval, security, privacy, purchasing, and records procedures. The time equivalence is supplied for the fictional meeting date, not a permanent conversion rule. Travel conditions belong only to the quoted options. This book teaches communication, not financial or legal advice, and does not authorize purchases, access changes, payments, or visitor entry.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / SCHEDULING ACROSS CALENDARS AND TIME ZONES

Clarify a missing time reference and read back two equivalent local times before issuing a meeting invitation.

> **Three o'clock in whose office?**
>
> Colleague Maya asks assistant Arun to arrange a 3:00 meeting with another office. For the fictional meeting date, 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office. Both calendars are open at that equivalent time, but the request does not identify whose clock Maya means. Arun must confirm the intended office reference before sending invitations. No meeting duration, location, or recurrence has been specified.

People: Maya, Colleague; Arun, Administrative assistant.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is missing from the initial request?

A. Whether both calendars are open at the stated equivalent time
B. Whether noon and 3:00 can be equivalent here
C. The assistant's name
D. Whose local time 3:00 refers to

2. What equivalence is supplied for this date?

A. Noon in Maya's office equals 3:00 elsewhere
B. The difference is permanently fixed for all dates
C. 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office
D. Both offices show 3:00 simultaneously

3. What should happen before invitations are sent?

A. Confirm the intended time reference
B. Assume the sender always means the recipient's time
C. Invent a meeting duration
D. Treat an open calendar as acceptance

Answers and explanations, page 108

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

local time
Clock time at the specified location.
confirm local time

time reference
Location or standard that gives a clock time meaning.
clarify the time reference

calendar availability
Time shown as open or occupied in a calendar.
check calendar availability

invitation
Message asking identified people to attend an event.
send the invitation

attendee
Person invited to or participating in a meeting.
confirm the attendee list

date-specific
Valid for the particular date being discussed.
use a date-specific conversion

time zone
Region using a defined civil-time reference.
identify the time zone

equivalent time
Different clock display representing the same moment elsewhere.
read back the equivalent time

meeting request
Proposal to arrange a meeting with specified details.
clarify the meeting request

organizer
Person responsible for arranging the meeting.
identify the organizer

noon
Twelve o'clock in the middle of the day.
specify noon

daylight saving time
Seasonal clock adjustment used in some locations; abbreviated DST.
check daylight saving time

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

local time LOCAL TIME

confirm local time

Keep the meaning precise: Clock time at the specified location.

meeting request MEETING REQUEST

clarify the meeting request

Keep the meaning precise: Proposal to arrange a meeting with specified details.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

Coordinated Universal Time

International time reference commonly abbreviated UTC.

identify Coordinated Universal Time

offset

Difference between one time reference and another.

verify the relevant offset

calendar entry

Event recorded in a scheduling system.

check the calendar entry

time display

Clock representation shown to a particular user.

compare the time displays

scheduling conflict

Overlap between incompatible calendar commitments.

resolve a scheduling conflict

free slot

Unoccupied period shown in a calendar.

identify a free slot

tentative hold

Provisional reservation not yet a final agreement.

distinguish a tentative hold

acceptance

Response agreeing to the stated invitation.

confirm acceptance

duration

Length of time an event is intended to last.

request the meeting duration

recurrence

Pattern under which an event repeats.

confirm recurrence separately

location field

Part of an invitation identifying where the meeting occurs.

complete the location field

schedule readback

Restatement of the agreed scheduling details.

give a schedule readback

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

daylight saving time DAYLIGHT SAVING TIME

check daylight saving time

Keep the meaning precise: Seasonal clock adjustment used in some locations; abbreviated DST.

scheduling conflict SCHEDULING CONFLICT

resolve a scheduling conflict

Keep the meaning precise: Overlap between incompatible calendar commitments.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Clarify the reference

Do you mean 3:00 in your office or the other office?

Explain the equivalence

On this date, your 3:00 is their noon.

Keep the question neutral

I want to make sure both offices receive the same meeting time.

State availability

Both calendars are open at that equivalent time.

Separate availability from intent

The calendars are open, but I still need your intended time.

Avoid duplicate clock labels

The two offices should not both be labeled 3:00.

Read back the location

You mean 3:00 in your office.

Read back the other clock

That will be noon in the other office.

Preserve the date

This conversion is for the meeting date we are discussing.

Avoid a permanent rule

I will not assume the same offset for every date.

Distinguish acceptance

An open slot is not an accepted invitation.

Hold the send

I will confirm the reference before sending.

Identify missing duration

How long should the meeting last?

Identify missing location

We still need the meeting location.

Keep recurrence separate

We have not agreed a repeating schedule.

Close the clarification

I have the intended office time and its equivalent clearly recorded.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State availability
Useful wording: Both calendars are open at that equivalent time.

Purpose: Separate availability from intent
Useful wording: The calendars are open, but I still need your intended time.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which clarification is best?

A. An open calendar means the time is obvious

B. I will send 3:00 to both offices

C. Does 3:00 refer to your office or the other office?

D. I assume every office uses your clock

2. Which entry preserves the clarified meeting without adding missing details?

A. One meeting: Maya 3:00, other office noon; one hour confirmed

B. One meeting: Maya's office 3:00, other office noon; duration pending

C. One meeting: both offices 3:00 local time; duration pending

D. One meeting: Maya noon, other office 3:00; duration pending

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Different clock display representing the same moment elsewhere. Which term fits?

A. attendee

B. duration

C. calendar entry

D. equivalent time

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Three o'clock in whose office?". Maya: "Yes, three here and noon there. Please don't put three next to both office names in the message." Arun: [missing response] Maya: "Is that enough to send it? The free slots were what I checked before asking you." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Agreed. There are two local time displays for one meeting, not two meetings at the same clock time.

B. Before I send anything, which time reference do you mean: three in your office or three in theirs?

C. The calendar availability helps, but I still need the duration and location. Neither was in the request.

D. That's the schedule readback. I'll keep it while we obtain the duration and location rather than assume either.

Answers and explanations, page 108

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The supplied equivalence is 3:00 in Maya's office and noon in the other office on the fictional date. Do not put 3:00 on both local displays or assume the same difference applies on every date.

E Conversation

Three o'clock in whose office?

Three o'clock in whose office?

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

time reference / meeting request / Recurrence / date-specific / schedule readback / equivalent time / Acceptance / calendar availability / local time / invitation

01 **Maya:** Could you set up three o'clock with the other office? Both calendars look open, so I'd like to get it arranged.

02 **Arun:** Before I send anything, which [1] _____ do you mean: three in your office or three in theirs?

03 **Maya:** Three here. I was looking at my own calendar and forgot that the other office would see a different time.

04 **Arun:** Thanks. On this date the [2] _____ there is noon. I'll state both offices so we're referring to the same meeting.

05 **Maya:** Yes, three here and noon there. Please don't put three next to both office names in the message.

06 **Arun:** Agreed. There are two [3] _____ displays for one meeting, not two meetings at the same clock time.

07 **Maya:** Is that enough to send it? The free slots were what I checked before asking you.

08 **Arun:** The [4] _____ helps, but I still need the duration and location. Neither was in the request.

09 **Maya:** I'll send those separately. For now, can you keep the intended time without filling in an hour by default?

10 **Arun:** Yes. I'll retain the [5] _____ as three here and noon there on this date, with those other details outstanding.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Three o'clock in whose office?

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Maya:** We may need another meeting with them later. Can I just use the same three-hour difference every time?

12 **Arun:** I'd check each date. This is a [6] _____ equivalence; it isn't a standing rule for future meetings.

13 **Maya:** Understood. Also, seeing a free slot doesn't mean their colleagues have agreed to attend, does it?

14 **Arun:** No. [7] _____ is a separate response. We shouldn't say they've agreed just because their calendars appear open.

15 **Maya:** Please keep the eventual message as a request, then. I don't want it to sound as though attendance is already settled.

16 **Arun:** The [8] _____ will ask them to attend at the clarified time, and we'll track their responses separately.

17 **Maya:** Let me check: three in my office, noon in theirs, on the date we're discussing. Nothing sent yet.

18 **Arun:** That's the [9] _____. I'll keep it while we obtain the duration and location rather than assume either.

19 **Maya:** I'll send those next. And this is only one meeting for now, not a weekly series.

20 **Arun:** Understood. [10] _____ hasn't been authorized. I'll wait for the remaining details before sending the single meeting request.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. time reference / **2.** equivalent time / **3.** local time / **4.** calendar availability / **5.** meeting request / **6.** date-specific / **7.** Acceptance / **8.** invitation / **9.** schedule readback / **10.** Recurrence

Why these answers fit, page 109

F Check accuracy and scope

Three o'clock in whose office?

Return to the case

Colleague Maya asks assistant Arun to arrange a 3:00 meeting with another office. For the fictional meeting date, 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office. Both calendars are open at that equivalent time, but the request does not identify whose clock Maya means. Arun must confirm the intended office reference before sending invitations. No meeting duration, location, or recurrence has been specified.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What does calendar availability establish?

A. Every invitee has accepted
B. The meeting lasts an hour
C. Recurrence is weekly
D. The relevant slot is open, not that the intended time is confirmed

2. Which detail must not be invented?

A. The missing time reference
B. The need to clarify before sending
C. A one-hour meeting duration
D. The supplied noon equivalent

Answers and explanations, page 110

Listen for the distinction

Read the two office times aloud as one meeting: 3:00 here, noon there, on the supplied date. Then read the unresolved duration and location.

A small clarification prevents a large scheduling error

A free calendar does not remove ambiguity in a spoken request. Ask whose local time is intended without suggesting that the colleague has made a foolish mistake. Once clarified, name both offices and their equivalent times in the readback.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Read back one meeting in two local times

Complete the scheduling clarification without adding a duration or treating availability as acceptance.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

open / time / noon / sending

01 **Assistant:** Whose local [1] _____ do you mean?

02 **Colleague:** Three in my office equals [2] _____ at the other office.

03 **Assistant:** Both calendars are [3] _____ at that time.

04 **Colleague:** Confirm the remaining details before [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. time / **2.** noon / **3.** open / **4.** sending

Why these answers fit, page 111

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Three o'clock in whose office?". Maya: "Understood. Also, seeing a free slot doesn't mean their colleagues have agreed to attend, does it?" Arun: [missing response] Maya: "Please keep the eventual message as a request, then. I don't want it to sound as though attendance is already settled." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The calendar availability helps, but I still need the duration and location. Neither was in the request.

B. The invitation will ask them to attend at the clarified time, and we'll track their responses separately.

C. I'd check each date. This is a date-specific equivalence; it isn't a standing rule for future meetings.

D. No. Acceptance is a separate response. We shouldn't say they've agreed just because their calendars appear open.

Answers and explanations, page 112

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / TAKING USEFUL CALLS AND PASSING ACCURATE MESSAGES

Route a caller by purpose, capture the reference and preferred reply route, and relay a requested deadline without guaranteeing it.

> **Delivery D18 belongs with facilities**
>
> Caller Lena Park needs the facilities team about delivery D18, not the finance team about an invoice. Facilities extension is 214. Lena requests a callback before 4:00, but team availability is unknown. Assistant Dev must confirm the delivery reference and preferred contact route, read back the message, and preserve the requested deadline as a request. The conversation supplies no payment problem or confirmed callback commitment.

People: Lena, Caller; Dev, Office assistant.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which team does Lena need?

A. Facilities
B. Finance
C. Payroll
D. An unidentified invoice department

2. What is the facilities extension?

A. 241
B. 412
C. D18
D. 214

3. How should before 4:00 be recorded?

A. A guaranteed response time
B. A confirmed payment deadline
C. A delivery time already agreed
D. A requested callback deadline

Answers and explanations, page 113

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

call routing
Directing a telephone inquiry to the appropriate recipient.

confirm call routing

finance team
Staff handling the relevant financial records and processes.

distinguish the finance team

delivery reference
Identifier attached to a particular delivery.

capture the delivery reference

purpose of call
Reason the caller needs contact.

clarify the purpose of call

callback request
Request for someone to return a telephone call.

relay a callback request

preferred contact route
Communication method selected by the caller.

confirm the preferred contact route

facilities team
Staff coordinating the relevant building or workplace services.

contact the facilities team

extension
Internal telephone number used within an organization.

confirm the extension

caller identity
Name and relevant identifying details of the person calling.

verify caller identity

message slip
Written record of a call for another person.

complete the message slip

requested deadline
Time by which the caller would like a response.

preserve the requested deadline

contact details
Information needed to reach the intended person.

verify contact details

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

call routing CALL ROUTING

confirm call routing

Keep the meaning precise: Directing a telephone inquiry to the appropriate recipient.

caller identity CALLER IDENTITY

verify caller identity

Keep the meaning precise: Name and relevant identifying details of the person calling.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

transfer
Connection of an existing call to another line.
distinguish a transfer from a callback

recipient availability
Whether the intended person or team can respond.
check recipient availability

reference correction
Amendment of a misheard identifier.
record a reference correction

misdirected call
Call sent to a recipient who does not handle its purpose.
prevent a misdirected call

call log
Record of telephone contacts and their relevant details.
update the call log

urgency
Stated need for prompt attention.
explain the urgency

voicemail
Recorded message left when a recipient is unavailable.
identify the voicemail option

message readback
Spoken repetition of a message to confirm its accuracy.
give a message readback

department
Organizational team with a defined function.
identify the correct department

response commitment
Agreed promise to reply at a specified time or stage.
distinguish a response commitment

recipient confirmation
Verification that the intended recipient has received or accepted the message.
obtain recipient confirmation

handoff note
Message passed to another person for follow-up.
prepare an accurate handoff note

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

contact details CONTACT DETAILS
verify contact details
Keep the meaning precise: Information needed to reach the intended person.

reference correction REFERENCE CORRECTION
record a reference correction
Keep the meaning precise: Amendment of a misheard identifier.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Clarify the purpose
Is this about the delivery or an invoice?

Ask for the reference
Could you confirm the delivery reference?

Name the extension
Facilities is on extension 214.

Ask for the route
How would you prefer the team to contact you?

Capture the timing
You are requesting a callback before 4:00.

Avoid an invented promise
I can relay the request, but I cannot guarantee that time.

Keep the purpose intact
This concerns delivery D18, not an invoice.

Invite a correction
Is any part of that message inaccurate?

Identify the team
You need facilities rather than finance.

Read back the identifier
That is D18, D followed by eighteen.

Confirm the caller
I have your name as Lena Park.

Verify the details
May I check the contact details for that route?

State the limit
I cannot confirm the team's availability.

Separate transfer and callback
Taking a message is not the same as connecting the call.

Read back the whole message
Lena Park requests facilities to call about D18 before 4:00.

Close honestly
I will pass on the requested deadline with the contact route.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Read back the identifier
Useful wording: That is D18, D followed by eighteen.

Purpose: Name the extension
Useful wording: Facilities is on extension 214.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which message is accurate?

A. Finance guarantees payment of invoice D18 at 4:00
B. Facilities has already returned the call
C. Lena has approved a new delivery charge
D. Lena Park requests facilities about delivery D18, callback before 4:00

2. Which response overpromises?

A. Please confirm your preferred contact route
B. They will definitely call before four
C. I will relay your requested deadline
D. Their availability is not confirmed

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Internal telephone number used within an organization. Which term fits?

A. recipient availability
B. call log
C. callback request
D. extension

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery D18 belongs with facilities". Lena: "Could they call me before four? That's when I need the delivery question answered." Dev: [missing response] Lena: "Please keep before four in the message, even if you can't confirm they'll meet it." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. The caller identity is Lena Park. I will keep your name, delivery D18, and the contact details together so the handoff is not ambiguous.

B. I will record a callback request before four. I cannot confirm their availability, so I should not promise that they can meet the requested time.

C. Thank you. I have the delivery reference as D18, D followed by eighteen. Facilities is the team you need, and their extension is 214.

D. Certainly. The requested deadline will stay in the message as before four. How would you prefer the team to contact you when they respond?

Answers and explanations, page 113

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The reference is delivery D18, and the team is facilities at extension 214. Do not turn the call into an invoice query for finance. A good message retains the name, purpose, reference, contact route, and requested deadline.

E Conversation

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

extension / purpose of call / callback request / caller identity / preferred contact route / requested deadline / message readback / handoff note / delivery reference / response commitment

01 **Lena:** Hello, Lena Park here. I was sent to finance about D18, but I think I need facilities.

02 **Dev:** Let me check the [1] _____ first. Are you calling about a delivery or an invoice? I want to make sure the message reaches the right team.

03 **Lena:** It's delivery D18, not an invoice. I'm trying to reach the facilities team.

04 **Dev:** Thank you. I have the [2] _____ as D18, D followed by eighteen. Facilities is the team you need, and their extension is 214.

05 **Lena:** Could they call me before four? That's when I need the delivery question answered.

06 **Dev:** I will record a [3] _____ before four. I cannot confirm their availability, so I should not promise that they can meet the requested time.

07 **Lena:** Please keep before four in the message, even if you can't confirm they'll meet it.

08 **Dev:** Certainly. The [4] _____ will stay in the message as before four. How would you prefer the team to contact you when they respond?

09 **Lena:** A telephone call, please. I'll confirm the contact number with you.

10 **Dev:** I will note the [5] _____ as telephone and verify the relevant details with you. I will not substitute email just because it is easier to forward.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Lena:** Use Lena Park, not just Lena. Another person here has called about a different delivery.

12 **Dev:** Yes. The [6] _____ is Lena Park. I will keep your name, delivery D18, and the contact details together so the handoff is not ambiguous.

13 **Lena:** Was the extension two-one-four? I wrote two-four-one and may have reversed the last digits.

14 **Dev:** It is [7] _____ 214, two-one-four. The delivery identifier remains D18. I will keep those two kinds of reference separate in the note.

15 **Lena:** Could you read the message back before we finish? I want to check the team and the delivery reference together.

16 **Dev:** Here is the [8] _____: Lena Park requests a telephone callback from facilities about delivery D18 before four. The contact details are to be verified, and team availability is not confirmed.

17 **Lena:** That's right. There isn't a finance approval or payment question to add.

18 **Dev:** Agreed. The [9] _____ will contain no payment or finance-approval request. Its purpose is to get the delivery question to the appropriate facilities colleagues.

19 **Lena:** Thank you. I understand you're passing on a request, not guaranteeing their response.

20 **Dev:** Exactly. A [10] _____ has not yet been established. I will relay the accurate request and keep the distinction clear.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. purpose of call / **2.** delivery reference / **3.** callback request / **4.** requested deadline / **5.** preferred contact route / **6.** caller identity / **7.** extension / **8.** message readback / **9.** handoff note / **10.** response commitment

Why these answers fit, page 114

F Check accuracy and scope

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities

Return to the case

Caller Lena Park needs the facilities team about delivery D18, not the finance team about an invoice. Facilities extension is 214. Lena requests a callback before 4:00, but team availability is unknown. Assistant Dev must confirm the delivery reference and preferred contact route, read back the message, and preserve the requested deadline as a request. The conversation supplies no payment problem or confirmed callback commitment.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which information still needs verification before the message is usable?

A. The actual contact details for Lena's chosen reply route
B. A new department because facilities cannot handle deliveries
C. A payment amount for the D18 invoice
D. A guaranteed four o'clock appointment with finance

2. Which number should Dev associate with facilities?

A. Delivery 214
B. Invoice 412
C. Extension 214
D. Extension 241

Answers and explanations, page 115

Listen for the distinction

Read back Lena Park, delivery D18, facilities extension 214, telephone preference, and requested before-four deadline. Keep request separate from guarantee.

Route by the purpose, not by the first familiar word

A delivery reference can sound like an invoice reference over the phone. Confirm the reason for the call before selecting a team. Taking a message is useful work, but it does not give the assistant control over the recipient's availability.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Pass on the caller's actual request

Complete the message summary. Keep the department, reference, extension, and deadline status accurate.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

facilities / 214 / deadline / D18

01 **Assistant:** Lena needs the [1] _____ team.

02 **Caller:** The delivery reference is [2] _____.

03 **Assistant:** The team extension is [3] _____.

04 **Caller:** Before 4:00 is my requested [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. facilities / **2.** D18 / **3.** 214 / **4.** deadline

Why these answers fit, page 116

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery D18 belongs with facilities". Lena: "Was the extension two-one-four? I wrote two-four-one and may have reversed the last digits." Dev: [missing response] Lena: "Could you read the message back before we finish? I want to check the team and the delivery reference together." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Agreed. The handoff note will contain no payment or finance-approval request. Its purpose is to get the delivery question to the appropriate facilities colleagues.

B. Thank you. I have the delivery reference as D18, D followed by eighteen. Facilities is the team you need, and their extension is 214.

C. It is extension 214, two-one-four. The delivery identifier remains D18. I will keep those two kinds of reference separate in the note.

D. Certainly. The requested deadline will stay in the message as before four. How would you prefer the team to contact you when they respond?

Answers and explanations, page 117

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Scheduling across calendars and time zones" and "Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Location or standard that gives a clock time meaning. Which term fits?

A. organizer
B. time reference
C. acceptance
D. offset

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Written record of a call for another person. Which term fits?

A. misdirected call
B. call routing
C. message slip
D. transfer

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Three o'clock in whose office?". Maya: "I'll send those separately. For now, can you keep the intended time without filling in an hour by default?" Arun: [missing response] Maya: "We may need another meeting with them later. Can I just use the same three-hour difference every time?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Thanks. On this date the equivalent time there is noon. I'll state both offices so we're referring to the same meeting.
B. Agreed. There are two local time displays for one meeting, not two meetings at the same clock time.
C. Yes. I'll retain the meeting request as three here and noon there on this date, with those other details outstanding.
D. Before I send anything, which time reference do you mean: three in your office or three in theirs?

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery D18 belongs with facilities". Lena: "That's right. There isn't a finance approval or payment question to add." Dev: [missing response] Lena: "Thank you. I understand you're passing on a request, not guaranteeing their response." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Certainly. The requested deadline will stay in the message as before four. How would you prefer the team to contact you when they respond?

B. Agreed. The handoff note will contain no payment or finance-approval request. Its purpose is to get the delivery question to the appropriate facilities colleagues.

C. Thank you. I have the delivery reference as D18, D followed by eighteen. Facilities is the team you need, and their extension is 214.

D. I will record a callback request before four. I cannot confirm their availability, so I should not promise that they can meet the requested time.

Answers and explanations, page 148

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / PREPARING MEETINGS AND CONFIRMING ACTION POINTS

Use the final minutes of a meeting to confirm an action owner, deliverable, deadline, and deferred agenda item.

> **Two quotes, not permission to buy**
>
> Ten minutes remain in an office meeting. The two outstanding agenda items are printer replacement and visitor signage. Chair Farah prioritizes the printer decision. Assistant Sam can obtain two quotations by Thursday, but nobody has approved a purchase. Sam must ask Farah to confirm that action and defer signage to the next meeting. The record must not turn quote gathering into an order or claim that signage has been rejected.

People: Sam, Administrative assistant; Farah, Meeting chair.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which item does the chair prioritize?

A. A new travel policy
B. A payment dispute
C. Printer replacement
D. Visitor signage

2. What can Sam deliver by Thursday?

A. Installed visitor signage
B. A guaranteed supplier discount
C. Two quotations
D. An approved printer purchase

3. What is the status of signage?

A. Rejected permanently
B. Already installed
C. Approved for immediate spending
D. To be deferred to the next meeting

Answers and explanations, page 118

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

agenda
Ordered list of topics for a meeting.
work through the agenda

agenda item
Individual topic listed for discussion.
prioritize an agenda item

chair
Person directing the meeting.
ask the chair to confirm

booklet imposition
Arrangement of document pages on print sheets so the folded booklet reads in the correct order.
confirm booklet imposition

priority item
Topic selected for attention before others.
identify the priority item

quotation
Supplier statement of a price and relevant terms.
obtain two quotations

quote gathering
Collecting supplier offers for later comparison.
assign quote gathering

purchase approval
Permission to buy the specified item.
distinguish purchase approval

action point
Agreed task arising from a discussion.
confirm the action point

action owner
Person responsible for completing the stated task.
name the action owner

deliverable
Specific output that a task is meant to produce.
define the deliverable

due date
Date by which a stated task should be completed.
record the due date

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

agenda AGENDA
work through the agenda
Keep the meaning precise: Ordered list of topics for a meeting.

quotation QUOTATION
obtain two quotations
Keep the meaning precise: Supplier statement of a price and relevant terms.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

minutes
Formal or agreed record of a meeting's proceedings.
correct the minutes

deferred item
Topic moved to a later discussion.
retain the deferred item

carry forward
Keep an unresolved item for later attention.
carry forward visitor signage

supplier comparison
Review of relevant differences between supplier offers.
prepare a supplier comparison

motion
Formal proposal presented for a meeting's decision where that procedure applies.
distinguish a motion from discussion

action readback
Spoken summary of the task and its limits.
give an action readback

decision log
Record of decisions and their scope.
update the decision log

duplex printing
Printing on both sides of a physical sheet.
specify duplex printing

procurement
Process of obtaining goods or services for an organization.
distinguish procurement stages

budget authority
Permission to commit funds within an identified scope.
confirm budget authority

consensus
Shared agreement among the relevant participants.
verify consensus

open item
Matter not yet resolved or completed.
preserve an open item

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

due date DUE DATE
record the due date
Keep the meaning precise: Date by which a stated task should be completed.

carry forward CARRY FORWARD
carry forward visitor signage
Keep the meaning precise: Keep an unresolved item for later attention.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Signal the time
We have ten minutes left.

Name the competing items
Printer replacement and visitor signage are still on the agenda.

Ask for direction
Which item should take priority?

Confirm the priority
We will use the remaining time for the printer item.

Offer a bounded action
I can obtain two quotes by Thursday.

Name the owner
Sam will gather the quotations.

Define the output
The deliverable is two supplier quotes.

Keep approval separate
No purchase has been approved.

Avoid an accidental order
Gathering quotes does not authorize me to buy.

Ask for confirmation
Can you confirm that as the action point?

Record the deadline
I will put Thursday in the action record.

Defer transparently
Shall we carry signage forward to the next meeting?

Avoid false rejection
Deferred does not mean rejected.

Preserve the open item
Signage remains on the follow-up agenda.

Read back the outcome
Sam: two quotes by Thursday; purchase not approved.

Close with shared wording
I will circulate the record with those limits clear.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Confirm the priority
Useful wording: We will use the remaining time for the printer item.

Purpose: Offer a bounded action
Useful wording: I can obtain two quotes by Thursday.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which action record is correct?

A. Sam to obtain two printer quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved
B. Sam to buy a printer today
C. Farah has selected a supplier
D. Signage installed by Thursday

2. What does deferred mean here?

A. Removed from all records
B. Moved to the next meeting
C. Rejected permanently
D. Approved for immediate purchase

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Arrangement of document pages on print sheets so the folded booklet reads in the correct order. Which term fits?

A. deferred item
B. motion
C. booklet imposition
D. action point

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two quotes, not permission to buy". Sam: "Shall I put my name against that action? I don't want the minutes to leave it as someone to get prices." Farah: [missing response] Sam: "I'll keep Thursday as the deadline, then. I haven't offered tomorrow, even though the replacement is becoming urgent." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That's the deliverable I need: two quotations. We haven't selected a supplier or authorized an order.

B. Yes, you're the action owner, Sam. Please record the two-quote task against your name.

C. Good. The minutes should distinguish the confirmed printer task from the postponed signage discussion.

D. That's enough. It remains an open item, with the next discussion identified but no invented date.

Answers and explanations, page 118

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Sam is the action owner. The deliverable is two quotes, due Thursday. No purchase has been approved. Obtaining prices and terms prepares a later decision; it does not establish supplier selection, an order, or installation.

E Conversation

Two quotes, not permission to buy

Two quotes, not permission to buy

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

priority item / deferred item / decision log / due date / deliverable / open item / action readback / purchase approval / minutes / action owner

01 **Sam:** We've got ten minutes left and two items: printer replacement and visitor signage. Which should take the remaining time?

02 **Farah:** Make the printer the [1] _____. Let's agree a useful next step rather than rush through both topics.

03 **Sam:** I can get two supplier quotes by Thursday. That will let us compare the offers, but it won't settle which printer to buy.

04 **Farah:** That's the [2] _____ I need: two quotations. We haven't selected a supplier or authorized an order.

05 **Sam:** Shall I put my name against that action? I don't want the minutes to leave it as someone to get prices.

06 **Farah:** Yes, you're the [3] _____, Sam. Please record the two-quote task against your name.

07 **Sam:** I'll keep Thursday as the deadline, then. I haven't offered tomorrow, even though the replacement is becoming urgent.

08 **Farah:** Thursday is the agreed [4] _____. Don't move it earlier in the minutes without checking whether that's achievable.

09 **Sam:** Can I put no order approved on the same line? A short note saying printer quotes can sound like the purchase is already agreed.

10 **Farah:** Yes. There is no [5] _____. We're gathering information for a later decision, not giving you spending authority.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Two quotes, not permission to buy

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Sam:** That leaves signage. Shall I carry it to the next meeting rather than mark it resolved because we've run out of time?

12 **Farah:** Record it as a [6] _____. It hasn't been rejected or completed; we still need to discuss it.

13 **Sam:** I'll include both outcomes in the summary, so signage doesn't disappear when people only read the action list.

14 **Farah:** Good. The [7] _____ should distinguish the confirmed printer task from the postponed signage discussion.

15 **Sam:** Here's the printer line: Sam to obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved and no supplier selected.

16 **Farah:** That's an accurate [8] _____. Keep the approval limit attached so it survives if the action is copied elsewhere.

17 **Sam:** For signage, I'll say next meeting. I haven't got a confirmed date for that meeting to add.

18 **Farah:** That's enough. It remains an [9] _____, with the next discussion identified but no invented date.

19 **Sam:** Then I have one task with an owner and deadline, and one item carried forward. I'll circulate that wording.

20 **Farah:** Please do. The [10] _____ needs to show what we agreed, not turn preparation into a purchase decision.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. priority item / **2.** deliverable / **3.** action owner / **4.** due date / **5.** purchase approval / **6.** deferred item / **7.** minutes / **8.** action readback / **9.** open item / **10.** decision log

Why these answers fit, page 119

F Check accuracy and scope

Two quotes, not permission to buy

Return to the case

Ten minutes remain in an office meeting. The two outstanding agenda items are printer replacement and visitor signage. Chair Farah prioritizes the printer decision. Assistant Sam can obtain two quotations by Thursday, but nobody has approved a purchase. Sam must ask Farah to confirm that action and defer signage to the next meeting. The record must not turn quote gathering into an order or claim that signage has been rejected.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which question closes the meeting usefully?

A. May I erase the signage item?
B. Which supplier did we already order from?
C. Can you confirm two quotes by Thursday as my action?
D. Should I assume all spending is approved?

2. Which claim exceeds the agreement?

A. Sam owns the quote action
B. Signage remains unresolved
C. A printer order is authorized
D. Two quotes are needed

Answers and explanations, page 120

Listen for the distinction

Read Sam's action and Farah's confirmation aloud: two quotes by Thursday, no purchase approval. Then read the separate signage deferral.

Close with actions that survive outside the room

People can leave the same meeting remembering different levels of agreement. Repeat the owner, deliverable, and due date before closing. Distinguish a decision to gather information from a purchase decision, and record a deferred item without making it disappear.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Close the meeting with a precise action record

Complete the action summary. Preserve the quotation task, deadline, and unresolved signage item.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

deferred / Thursday / Sam / quotations

01 **Chair:** The action owner is [1] _____.

02 **Assistant:** I will obtain two [2] _____.

03 **Chair:** The due date is [3] _____.

04 **Assistant:** Visitor signage is [4] _____ to the next meeting.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. Sam / **2.** quotations / **3.** Thursday / **4.** deferred

Why these answers fit, page 121

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two quotes, not permission to buy". Sam: "I'll include both outcomes in the summary, so signage doesn't disappear when people only read the action list." Farah: [missing response] Sam: "Here's the printer line: Sam to obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved and no supplier selected." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That's the deliverable I need: two quotations. We haven't selected a supplier or authorized an order.

B. Good. The minutes should distinguish the confirmed printer task from the postponed signage discussion.

C. That's enough. It remains an open item, with the next discussion identified but no invented date.

D. Yes, you're the action owner, Sam. Please record the two-quote task against your name.

Answers and explanations, page 122

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / CHECKING DOCUMENT VERSIONS AND ACCESS

Correct an outdated document message and request appropriate viewing access without independently widening the audience.

Correct version, missing permission

Assistant Elena sent version 2 of the visitor guide. Version 3 was approved this morning, and the older guide gives the wrong reception floor. The current guide is in the shared folder, but recipient Kai cannot view it. Elena must identify the correction, direct recipients to approved version 3, and ask the document owner to resolve Kai's viewing access. The correct floor number and the identity of the owner are not supplied; neither should be invented.

People: Kai, Guide recipient; Elena, Administrative assistant.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which version is current?

A. Version 2 because it was emailed
B. Both versions equally
C. An invented version 4
D. Version 3, approved this morning

2. What is wrong in version 2?

A. The meeting duration
B. The reception floor
C. The supplier quantity
D. A confirmed ticket price

3. Who should resolve Kai's access?

A. Elena by making the folder public
B. Kai by forwarding the old version
C. Any recipient by guessing a password
D. The document owner through the appropriate process

Answers and explanations, page 123

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

document version
Identified revision of a file or publication.
check the document version

approved version
Revision accepted for the stated use.
use the approved version

superseded
Replaced by a newer applicable version.
mark the guide as superseded

current guide
Document presently valid for the intended purpose.
link to the current guide

shared folder
Storage location available to users with relevant permissions.
locate the shared folder

document owner
Person responsible for the file and relevant access decisions.
contact the document owner

viewing access
Permission to open and read the content.
request viewing access

editing permission
Authority to modify the content.
distinguish editing permission

access request
Request for an appropriate permission to be granted.
submit an access request

permission scope
Range of people and actions covered by an access setting.
preserve permission scope

mail merge
Creation of personalized documents by combining a template with selected source records.
preview the mail merge

attachment
File included with a message.
replace the outdated attachment

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

document version DOCUMENT VERSION

check the document version

Keep the meaning precise: Identified revision of a file or publication.

document owner DOCUMENT OWNER

contact the document owner

Keep the meaning precise: Person responsible for the file and relevant access decisions.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

document link
Address pointing to a stored file.
share the current document link

approval date
Date on which the relevant revision was accepted.
verify the approval date

merge field
Placeholder that inserts a specified source value into a personalized document.
verify the merge field

distribution list
Set of recipients for a message or document.
check the distribution list

read-only
Allowing viewing without permission to change content.
request read-only access

revision control
Management of document versions and their status.
maintain revision control

version history
Record of changes or saved revisions.
consult version history

correction notice
Message identifying an error and its replacement.
send a correction notice

access error
Message or condition preventing permitted use of a resource.
report an access error

unrestricted link
Link that does not limit access to the intended named audience.
avoid an unrestricted link

source location
Place where the authoritative file is stored.
identify the source location

replacement message
Updated communication that corrects an earlier one.
issue a replacement message

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

attachment ATTACHMENT

replace the outdated attachment

Keep the meaning precise: File included with a message.

merge field MERGE FIELD

verify the merge field

Keep the meaning precise: Placeholder that inserts a specified source value into a personalized document.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Own the error
I sent version 2 in my earlier message.

Identify the affected detail
The older guide gives the wrong reception floor.

Avoid guessed directions
I will not quote a floor number I have not verified.

Acknowledge the obstacle
You are receiving an access error.

Keep editing separate
Viewing access is not a request for editing rights.

Avoid widening access
I will not make the folder available to everyone.

Correct the distribution
I will send the correction to the affected recipients.

Keep completion honest
Access has been requested, not confirmed.

Name the replacement
Version 3 was approved this morning.

Direct recipients clearly
Please use version 3 in the shared folder.

Ask about access
Can you open the current guide?

Name the needed permission
You need viewing access to the approved guide.

Route the request
I will ask the document owner to resolve the permission.

Retire the old reference
The earlier attachment is superseded.

Preserve the authoritative source
The current file remains in the shared folder.

Close with two actions
Replace the outdated reference and resolve viewing access.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Direct recipients clearly
Useful wording: Please use version 3 in the shared folder.

Purpose: Avoid guessed directions
Useful wording: I will not quote a floor number I have not verified.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which correction is accurate?

A. Use either version because both arrived by email
B. Reception is on an invented floor
C. Version 4 has automatically replaced both files
D. Use approved version 3; version 2 has the wrong reception floor

2. What permission does Kai need here?

A. Permission to edit every file
B. A public link for anyone
C. Viewing access
D. Ownership of the folder

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Document presently valid for the intended purpose. Which term fits?

A. read-only
B. approval date
C. current guide
D. access request

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct version, missing permission". Kai: "I tried that link. It says I don't have permission, so I can only open the old attachment." Elena: [missing response] Kai: "Could you just make the link open to anyone? That might be quicker than waiting for the owner." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No. It's superseded and contains a known error. Leaving it as the active guide would keep sending people to the wrong place.

B. I'll make the access request specific: Kai needs to view the approved visitor guide, version 3, and the current link returns an error.

C. I shouldn't widen the permission scope on my own. I'll request access for you, not open the folder to an unrestricted audience.

D. Then you need viewing access to version 3. I'll ask the document owner to resolve that separately from correcting my earlier message.

Answers and explanations, page 123

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Version 3 was approved this morning. Version 2 contains the wrong reception floor and should not remain the active guide. The brief does not supply the correct floor number, so the correction must point to the current guide rather than invent directions.

E Conversation

Correct version, missing permission

Correct version, missing permission

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

permission scope / access error / correction notice / viewing access / document owner / superseded / current guide / replacement message / access request / approved version

01 **Kai:** I've got your emailed visitor guide and a message about a newer one. Which should I use for the people arriving today?

02 **Elena:** Use the [1] _____, version 3, approved this morning. I sent version 2 earlier, and its reception-floor information is wrong. I'm sorry for the confusion.

03 **Kai:** Can you tell me the correct floor now? I don't want to forward two different sets of directions.

04 **Elena:** I need to verify it in the [2] _____. I won't guess a number; version 3 in the shared folder is the replacement source.

05 **Kai:** I tried that link. It says I don't have permission, so I can only open the old attachment.

06 **Elena:** Then you need [3] _____ to version 3. I'll ask the document owner to resolve that separately from correcting my earlier message.

07 **Kai:** Could you just make the link open to anyone? That might be quicker than waiting for the owner.

08 **Elena:** I shouldn't widen the [4] _____ on my own. I'll request access for you, not open the folder to an unrestricted audience.

09 **Kai:** I only need to read it. Please don't ask for editing rights on my behalf.

10 **Elena:** I'll make the [5] _____ specific: Kai needs to view the approved visitor guide, version 3, and the current link returns an error.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Correct version, missing permission

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Kai:** While that's pending, should I leave the old attachment in the visitor email as a temporary fallback?

12 **Elena:** No. It's [6] _____ and contains a known error. Leaving it as the active guide would keep sending people to the wrong place.

13 **Kai:** Please make the correction easy to spot. There are several messages in the thread, and a quiet edit would be missed.

14 **Elena:** I'll send a clear [7] _____ identifying the earlier attachment, the reception-floor error, and version 3 as its replacement.

15 **Kai:** Once you've sent the owner the request, can I tell my colleague the link is fixed?

16 **Elena:** Not yet. The [8] _____ remains unresolved until the permission and actual access are confirmed. I'll describe the request as pending.

17 **Kai:** So one action corrects the information for everyone who received it, and the other resolves my ability to open the right file.

18 **Elena:** Exactly. The [9] _____ will correct the reference, while the access request stays visible as a separate follow-up.

19 **Kai:** Thank you. I won't forward version 2 or say I can open version 3 until it's working.

20 **Elena:** I'll keep the [10] _____ involved and report the confirmed status. The next update won't invent a floor number or claim the access change is complete.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. approved version / **2.** current guide / **3.** viewing access / **4.** permission scope / **5.** access request / **6.** superseded / **7.** correction notice / **8.** access error / **9.** replacement message / **10.** document owner

Why these answers fit, page 124

F Check accuracy and scope

Correct version, missing permission

Return to the case

Assistant Elena sent version 2 of the visitor guide. Version 3 was approved this morning, and the older guide gives the wrong reception floor. The current guide is in the shared folder, but recipient Kai cannot view it. Elena must identify the correction, direct recipients to approved version 3, and ask the document owner to resolve Kai's viewing access. The correct floor number and the identity of the owner are not supplied; neither should be invented.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which action exceeds Elena's supplied authority?

A. Making the folder public
B. Asking the owner for viewing access
C. Correcting the earlier message
D. Identifying version 2 as superseded

2. What should Elena avoid claiming?

A. Version 2 gives the wrong floor
B. The owner should receive the request
C. Kai's access is fixed before confirmation
D. Version 3 was approved this morning

Answers and explanations, page 126

Listen for the distinction

Read the correction and access request aloud. Name version 3, the outdated reception-floor detail, viewing access, and the document owner.

Own the correction and separate the access problem

An apology should point clearly to the replacement source. A broken permission is a second issue, not a reason to recirculate the inaccurate attachment or make the folder available to everyone. Describe the access needed and route the request to the owner.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Correct the guide and request the right access

Complete the document handoff. Identify the current version, the known error, and the appropriate permission route.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

viewing / floor / owner / 3

01 **Assistant:** The approved guide is version [1] _____.

02 **Recipient:** The older version has the wrong reception [2] _____.

03 **Assistant:** You need [3] _____ access to the current guide.

04 **Recipient:** Please ask the document [4] _____ to resolve it.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 3 / **2.** floor / **3.** viewing / **4.** owner

Why these answers fit, page 126

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct version, missing permission". Kai: "Please make the correction easy to spot. There are several messages in the thread, and a quiet edit would be missed." Elena: [missing response] Kai: "Once you've sent the owner the request, can I tell my colleague the link is fixed?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. The replacement message will correct the reference, while the access request stays visible as a separate follow-up.

B. Not yet. The access error remains unresolved until the permission and actual access are confirmed. I'll describe the request as pending.

C. I'll send a clear correction notice identifying the earlier attachment, the reception-floor error, and version 3 as its replacement.

D. Then you need viewing access to version 3. I'll ask the document owner to resolve that separately from correcting my earlier message.

Answers and explanations, page 127

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Preparing meetings and confirming action points" and "Checking document versions and access". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Person directing the meeting. Which term fits?

A. decision log
B. purchase approval
C. budget authority
D. chair

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Authority to modify the content. Which term fits?

A. distribution list
B. document link
C. document version
D. editing permission

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery D18 belongs with facilities". Lena: "A telephone call, please. I'll confirm the contact number with you." Dev: [missing response] Lena: "Use Lena Park, not just Lena. Another person here has called about a different delivery." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Let me check the purpose of call first. Are you calling about a delivery or an invoice? I want to make sure the message reaches the right team.
B. Yes. The caller identity is Lena Park. I will keep your name, delivery D18, and the contact details together so the handoff is not ambiguous.
C. I will note the preferred contact route as telephone and verify the relevant details with you. I will not substitute email just because it is easier to forward.
D. I will record a callback request before four. I cannot confirm their availability, so I should not promise that they can meet the requested time.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct version, missing permission". Kai: "So one action corrects the information for everyone who received it, and the other resolves my ability to open the right file." Elena: [missing response] Kai: "Thank you. I won't forward version 2 or say I can open version 3 until it's working." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Not yet. The access error remains unresolved until the permission and actual access are confirmed. I'll describe the request as pending.

B. Then you need viewing access to version 3. I'll ask the document owner to resolve that separately from correcting my earlier message.

C. Exactly. The replacement message will correct the reference, while the access request stays visible as a separate follow-up.

D. I'll send a clear correction notice identifying the earlier attachment, the reception-floor error, and version 3 as its replacement.

Answers and explanations, page 150

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / QUERYING OFFICE SUPPLIES AND DELIVERY DIFFERENCES

Present a documented quantity discrepancy and request the missing supply information without inventing a cause or approving payment.

> **Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment**
>
> Purchase order P44 is for twelve archive boxes. The delivery note also lists twelve, but assistant Omar has checked the shipment and counted ten. No second package or backorder is documented. Supplier contact Leila must receive a factual query asking about the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. Omar has no basis to allege theft, assume a split delivery, or approve payment from the information available.

People: Omar, Office assistant; Leila, Supplier contact.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. How many archive boxes were ordered?

A. Twelve
B. Ten
C. Two
D. Twenty-two

2. What quantity was physically checked?

A. An uncounted second package
B. Ten boxes
C. Twelve boxes
D. Two boxes

3. What is documented about a second shipment?

A. Nothing is confirmed
B. It definitely arrives tomorrow
C. It was received yesterday
D. It has been canceled by Omar

Answers and explanations, page 128

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

purchase order
Formal order record specifying requested goods or services; abbreviated PO.

quote the purchase order

ordered quantity
Number of units requested on the order.

verify the ordered quantity

checked count
Quantity established by the stated physical check.

report the checked count

quantity discrepancy
Difference between relevant stated or counted quantities.

report a quantity discrepancy

backorder
Order quantity awaiting later fulfillment.

verify a documented backorder

second package
Additional parcel distinct from the checked one.

verify a second package

archive box
Container used to store records or documents.

order archive boxes

delivery note
Document listing goods associated with a delivery.

compare the delivery note

short delivery
Receipt of fewer units than the order or document specifies.

query a short delivery

outstanding quantity
Ordered amount not yet accounted for as received.

confirm the outstanding quantity

split shipment
Order delivered in more than one consignment.

confirm a split shipment

shipment plan
Stated arrangement for dispatching the remaining goods.

request the shipment plan

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

purchase order PURCHASE ORDER

quote the purchase order

Keep the meaning precise: Formal order record specifying requested goods or services; abbreviated PO.

short delivery SHORT DELIVERY

query a short delivery

Keep the meaning precise: Receipt of fewer units than the order or document specifies.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

supplier query

Request to clarify information held by the vendor.

raise a supplier query

order reference

Identifier connecting an inquiry to the correct order.

include the order reference

receipt record

Account of goods actually received.

preserve the receipt record

dispatch record

Information documenting goods sent from the supplier.

check the dispatch record

packing list

List describing the contents assigned to a package or shipment.

compare the packing list

unit count

Number of individual items rather than cartons or sets.

confirm the unit count

fulfillment

Completion of the relevant supply obligation.

distinguish partial fulfillment

partial receipt

Receipt of only part of the ordered amount.

record a partial receipt

payment approval

Authorization to pay the relevant charge.

keep payment approval separate

supplier response

Information returned in answer to the query.

request a supplier response

unverified explanation

Possible cause not established by the evidence.

avoid an unverified explanation

delivery reconciliation

Comparison of order, documents, and received quantities.

complete delivery reconciliation

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

shipment plan SHIPMENT PLAN

request the shipment plan

Keep the meaning precise: Stated arrangement for dispatching the remaining goods.

packing list PACKING LIST

compare the packing list

Keep the meaning precise: List describing the contents assigned to a package or shipment.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Identify the order
I am calling about purchase order P44.

State the ordered amount
The order is for twelve archive boxes.

State the document amount
The delivery note also lists twelve.

State the checked count
We checked the shipment and counted ten.

Calculate the difference
Two boxes are not accounted for in this receipt.

Use neutral language
There is a quantity discrepancy to resolve.

Ask about outstanding supply
Can you confirm the outstanding two boxes?

Check for another shipment
Is a further shipment planned?

Avoid assuming a backorder
We have no documented backorder.

Avoid inventing a package
No second package is recorded.

Separate document and receipt
The note lists twelve, but our checked receipt is ten.

Request the supporting record
Please check the dispatch information against P44.

Keep the cause open
We have not established why the quantities differ.

Avoid an accusation
I am reporting the count, not alleging theft.

Preserve approval limits
This query does not approve payment.

Close with the requested response
Please confirm the remaining quantity and shipment position.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the checked count
Useful wording: We checked the shipment and counted ten.

Purpose: Calculate the difference
Useful wording: Two boxes are not accounted for in this receipt.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which statement preserves all three quantities?

A. P44 orders ten and all twelve arrived

B. The note proves twelve were received

C. Two additional boxes have definitely shipped

D. P44 orders twelve, the note lists twelve, and the checked shipment contains ten

2. What is the outstanding difference?

A. Twenty-two boxes

B. Two boxes

C. Twelve boxes

D. Ten boxes

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Document listing goods associated with a delivery. Which term fits?

A. backorder

B. receipt record

C. payment approval

D. delivery note

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment". Omar: "There isn't a second package or backorder recorded here. Has something been sent separately?" Leila: [missing response] Omar: "Please confirm the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. I need both points answered." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will make the requested supplier response specific to those questions. Until then, the record remains ten received against twelve ordered, with two still unaccounted for.

B. I will check the outstanding quantity against P44 and ask about the shipment position. At this point, I do not have a confirmed dispatch date to give you.

C. Understood. A split shipment has not been documented in the information you have. I need to check rather than tell you another package is already on its way.

D. You should preserve the checked count of ten in this query. We need to resolve the mismatch, not make it disappear by replacing the physical count with the document figure.

Answers and explanations, page 128

One useful distinction

Twelve were ordered and twelve appear on the delivery note, but ten were checked in the shipment. The difference is two. Do not change the checked count to match the paper or claim that the missing two have already been dispatched.

E Conversation

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

ordered quantity / order reference / Payment approval / split shipment / outstanding quantity / quantity discrepancy / checked count / supplier query / supplier response / dispatch record

01 **Omar:** Could you check P44, our archive-box order? The quantity on the paperwork doesn't match what we received.

02 **Leila:** Certainly. Please give me the [1] _____ first, then the delivery-note figure and your checked count. That will help me keep the three records separate.

03 **Omar:** We ordered twelve. The note says twelve too, but I've checked the shipment and counted ten.

04 **Leila:** Then the [2] _____ is two boxes. I will not treat the delivery-note figure as proof that twelve were physically received at your office.

05 **Omar:** There isn't a second package or backorder recorded here. Has something been sent separately?

06 **Leila:** Understood. A [3] _____ has not been documented in the information you have. I need to check rather than tell you another package is already on its way.

07 **Omar:** Please confirm the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. I need both points answered.

08 **Leila:** I will check the [4] _____ against P44 and ask about the shipment position. At this point, I do not have a confirmed dispatch date to give you.

09 **Omar:** Keep archive boxes beside P44, please. We've got several office-supply orders open.

10 **Leila:** I will retain the [5] _____ and the archive-box description together. The query is twelve ordered, twelve on the note, ten checked, with two outstanding.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Omar:** Should I leave the receiving record at ten while you check? Someone suggested matching it to the delivery note.

12 **Leila:** You should preserve the [6] _____ of ten in this query. We need to resolve the mismatch, not make it disappear by replacing the physical count with the document figure.

13 **Omar:** I want to report the difference without blaming the driver. We don't know why it happened.

14 **Leila:** Agreed. The [7] _____ can ask for confirmation without alleging theft or blaming a particular person. The current evidence does not establish a cause.

15 **Omar:** Could you compare the dispatch record with P44? I don't want to assume the missing two were held back.

16 **Leila:** I will request the relevant [8] _____ check. I will not say the boxes were held back unless the information supports that explanation.

17 **Omar:** And this query isn't payment approval or permission to close the discrepancy.

18 **Leila:** Understood. [9] _____ is not part of this exchange. The query remains open while the outstanding quantity and any further shipment are being confirmed.

19 **Omar:** Please come back with the quantity and shipment position, not just an acknowledgment that you received the query.

20 **Leila:** I will make the requested [10] _____ specific to those questions. Until then, the record remains ten received against twelve ordered, with two still unaccounted for.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. ordered quantity / **2.** quantity discrepancy / **3.** split shipment / **4.** outstanding quantity / **5.** order reference / **6.** checked count / **7.** supplier query / **8.** dispatch record / **9.** Payment approval / **10.** supplier response

Why these answers fit, page 129

F Check accuracy and scope

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

Return to the case

Purchase order P44 is for twelve archive boxes. The delivery note also lists twelve, but assistant Omar has checked the shipment and counted ten. No second package or backorder is documented. Supplier contact Leila must receive a factual query asking about the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. Omar has no basis to allege theft, assume a split delivery, or approve payment from the information available.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which question is justified?

A. Can I record a second delivery as completed?
B. Which payment have we already approved?
C. Is another shipment planned for the outstanding two?
D. Why did your driver steal two boxes?

2. Which record should remain accurate?

A. An invented receipt of twelve
B. A confirmed backorder with no evidence
C. An automatic payment approval
D. The checked receipt of ten

Answers and explanations, page 130

Listen for the distinction

Read the quantities aloud: twelve ordered, twelve on the note, ten counted, two outstanding. Then ask the supplied further-shipment question.

Use matching references and neutral discrepancy language

A clear supplier query separates the order, the document, and the checked physical count. Ask for confirmation of the outstanding quantity and delivery position. An unexplained difference is not proof of dishonesty, and a document alone does not establish receipt.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

State the supply discrepancy without guessing

Complete the supplier query using the documented order and checked receipt.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

P44 / ten / twelve / two

01 **Assistant:** The purchase order is [1] _____.

02 **Supplier:** The order and delivery note both list [2] _____ boxes.

03 **Assistant:** The checked shipment contains [3] _____ boxes.

04 **Supplier:** The outstanding difference is [4] _____ boxes.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. P44 / **2.** twelve / **3.** ten / **4.** two

Why these answers fit, page 131

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment". Omar: "I want to report the difference without blaming the driver. We don't know why it happened." Leila: [missing response] Omar: "Could you compare the dispatch record with P44? I don't want to assume the missing two were held back." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Certainly. Please give me the ordered quantity first, then the delivery-note figure and your checked count. That will help me keep the three records separate.

B. Agreed. The supplier query can ask for confirmation without alleging theft or blaming a particular person. The current evidence does not establish a cause.

C. Then the quantity discrepancy is two boxes. I will not treat the delivery-note figure as proof that twelve were physically received at your office.

D. Understood. Payment approval is not part of this exchange. The query remains open while the outstanding quantity and any further shipment are being confirmed.

Answers and explanations, page 132

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / WELCOMING VISITORS AND CHECKING ARRANGEMENTS

Welcome a visitor, distinguish two possible hosts, and explain the waiting arrangement while preserving the actual access boundary.

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

Visitor Taylor arrives for a 10:00 meeting with Jordan. Two colleagues share that first name: Jordan Chen in facilities and Jordan Patel in sales. Visitor reference V12 names Jordan Chen. Receptionist Nia must check the reference, contact the correct host, and explain that Taylor should wait at reception. Taylor is not cleared to enter other areas alone. No host arrival time or further access permission has been confirmed.

People: Taylor, Visitor; Nia, Receptionist.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which Jordan is named on V12?

A. Both Jordans jointly
B. An unnamed finance colleague
C. Jordan Chen in facilities
D. Jordan Patel in sales

2. Where should Taylor wait?

A. In any available meeting room
B. At the sales desk without checking
C. At reception
D. Alone in the facilities work area

3. What is not confirmed?

A. The scheduled 10:00 meeting
B. The existence of two Jordans
C. When the host will reach reception
D. The reference V12

Answers and explanations, page 133

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

reception
Area where visitors first report and are assisted.
wait at reception

host
Person responsible for receiving the visitor.
contact the host

surname
Family name used to distinguish people with the same first name.
confirm the surname

sales
Business function associated with selling products or services.
distinguish the sales colleague

arrival
Visitor's appearance at the location.
acknowledge the arrival

waiting area
Designated place where a person remains before being received.
explain the waiting area

visitor reference
Identifier linking a visitor to an arrangement.
check the visitor reference

appointment record
Information describing a scheduled visit or meeting.
check the appointment record

facilities
Workplace function associated with relevant building services.
identify the facilities host

scheduled time
Time recorded for the arranged meeting.
confirm the scheduled time

check-in
Initial process for recording or verifying a visitor's arrival.
complete the check-in

host notification
Message informing the host that the visitor has arrived.
send the host notification

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

reception RECEPTION

wait at reception

Keep the meaning precise: Area where visitors first report and are assisted.

facilities FACILITIES

identify the facilities host

Keep the meaning precise: Workplace function associated with relevant building services.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

access clearance

Confirmed permission to enter a defined area.

verify access clearance

escort

Authorized person accompanying a visitor where required.

confirm the escort arrangement

visitor log

Record of arrivals and relevant visit details.

update the visitor log

identity match

Agreement between the person or name and the relevant record.

verify the identity match

reception wait

Period spent at reception pending the next arrangement.

explain the reception wait

arrival estimate

Expected arrival time that has not necessarily been confirmed.

qualify an arrival estimate

unaccompanied access

Permission to enter or move without an escort.

distinguish unaccompanied access

visitor badge

Identifier issued under the relevant visitor procedure.

follow the visitor-badge procedure

restricted area

Space whose entry is limited by the applicable rules.

identify a restricted area

appointment ambiguity

Uncertainty about which arrangement or host is intended.

resolve appointment ambiguity

host availability

Whether the intended host can presently respond.

check host availability

visitor handoff

Transfer of responsibility for receiving the visitor.

coordinate the visitor handoff

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

host notification HOST NOTIFICATION

send the host notification

Keep the meaning precise: Message informing the host that the visitor has arrived.

visitor log VISITOR LOG

update the visitor log

Keep the meaning precise: Record of arrivals and relevant visit details.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Open warmly
Good morning. Who are you here to see?

Explain the ambiguity
We have two colleagues called Jordan.

Read back the identifier
I have V12.

Distinguish the department
Jordan Chen is in facilities, not sales.

Explain the wait
Please wait here at reception while I contact Jordan.

Avoid invented timing
I do not yet have a confirmed arrival time for the host.

Separate appointment and entry
The meeting reference does not give unaccompanied access.

Check the understanding
Is the host name on that readback correct?

Acknowledge the booking
You have a 10:00 meeting with Jordan.

Ask for the reference
May I check your visitor reference?

Confirm the full name
That reference names Jordan Chen.

State the next action
I will contact your host.

Keep the tone helpful
I want to make sure you reach the correct person.

Keep access explicit
You are not cleared to enter the other areas alone.

Preserve the record
I will keep V12 with your arrival message.

Close with the arrangement
Jordan Chen will be contacted; please remain at reception for the next update.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Ask for the reference
Useful wording: May I check your visitor reference?

Purpose: Read back the identifier
Useful wording: I have V12.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which host message is accurate?

A. Taylor is meeting Jordan Patel in sales
B. Both Jordans must attend
C. Taylor has entered facilities alone
D. Taylor is at reception for V12 with Jordan Chen at 10:00

2. Which sentence is courteous and accurate?

A. Your appointment means you can enter alone
B. Please wait at reception while I contact Jordan Chen
C. Go anywhere while we look for Jordan
D. Jordan will definitely be here in two minutes

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Information describing a scheduled visit or meeting. Which term fits?

A. escort
B. arrival
C. reception wait
D. appointment record

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two Jordans, one visitor reference". Taylor: "Yes, Jordan Chen is right. I might have ended up in sales if you hadn't checked." Nia: [missing response] Taylor: "Do you know if Jordan's already coming down? The meeting is at ten." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Jordan Chen in facilities. Confirming the surname prevents confusion with Jordan Patel in sales. Your reference is V12, and you are waiting here at reception.

B. I will send the host notification to Jordan Chen, using V12 and your name. Please wait here at reception while I make contact.

C. Welcome. May I check the visitor reference? We have two colleagues called Jordan, so I want to contact the right person before directing you anywhere.

D. Thank you. The appointment record names Jordan Chen in facilities. The other colleague is Jordan Patel in sales, so we have resolved that ambiguity.

Answers and explanations, page 133

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Reference V12 names Jordan Chen in facilities, not Jordan Patel in sales. The first name alone is insufficient because both colleagues are called Jordan. Preserve the reference and full name when contacting the host.

E Conversation

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

host notification / visitor handoff / host availability / arrival / surname / reception wait / waiting area / appointment record / unaccompanied access / visitor reference

01 **Taylor:** Good morning, Taylor here for a ten o'clock meeting with Jordan. I've got the confirmation on my phone.

02 **Nia:** Welcome. May I check the [1] _____? We have two colleagues called Jordan, so I want to contact the right person before directing you anywhere.

03 **Taylor:** It's V12. I remembered Jordan's first name but not the surname.

04 **Nia:** Thank you. The [2] _____ names Jordan Chen in facilities. The other colleague is Jordan Patel in sales, so we have resolved that ambiguity.

05 **Taylor:** Yes, Jordan Chen is right. I might have ended up in sales if you hadn't checked.

06 **Nia:** I will send the [3] _____ to Jordan Chen, using V12 and your name. Please wait here at reception while I make contact.

07 **Taylor:** Do you know if Jordan's already coming down? The meeting is at ten.

08 **Nia:** I have not confirmed [4] _____ yet. I can contact Jordan, but I do not want to promise an arrival time before I have that information.

09 **Taylor:** Could I wait near the facilities office instead, so I'm easier to find?

10 **Nia:** Please remain in the [5] _____ here for now. You have not been cleared to enter the other areas alone, and I do not want to send you beyond the current arrangement.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Taylor:** Understood. I thought the meeting confirmation might be enough to go through.

12 **Nia:** Yes. The reference identifies your visit; it does not itself establish [6] _____ . I will keep the next step clear while we contact the correct host.

13 **Taylor:** Please tell Jordan I've arrived, rather than just asking whether the meeting's still on.

14 **Nia:** Certainly. The [7] _____ message will say Taylor is at reception for the ten o'clock meeting, reference V12. It will not describe this as a new booking request.

15 **Taylor:** Reception is fine. I don't need a different room; I just need Jordan to know where I am.

16 **Nia:** I will keep the [8] _____ as the arrangement. No alternative room or entry route has been agreed, so I will not add one to the message.

17 **Taylor:** Could you repeat the full name and department once? I'd like to use the right surname.

18 **Nia:** Jordan Chen in facilities. Confirming the [9] _____ prevents confusion with Jordan Patel in sales. Your reference is V12, and you are waiting here at reception.

19 **Taylor:** Thank you. I'll stay here for the next update.

20 **Nia:** You are welcome. I will coordinate the [10] _____ once the host response is available. For now, the correct host has been identified and the waiting instruction is clear.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. visitor reference / **2.** appointment record / **3.** host notification / **4.** host availability / **5.** waiting area / **6.** unaccompanied access / **7.** arrival / **8.** reception wait / **9.** surname / **10.** visitor handoff

Why these answers fit, page 134

F Check accuracy and scope

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

Return to the case

Visitor Taylor arrives for a 10:00 meeting with Jordan. Two colleagues share that first name: Jordan Chen in facilities and Jordan Patel in sales. Visitor reference V12 names Jordan Chen. Receptionist Nia must check the reference, contact the correct host, and explain that Taylor should wait at reception. Taylor is not cleared to enter other areas alone. No host arrival time or further access permission has been confirmed.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What resolves the first-name ambiguity?

A. V12 and the full host name
B. Assuming sales receives every visitor
C. Choosing the first Jordan in a directory
D. Treating both names as interchangeable

2. Which fact must remain separate from the booking?

A. The reference V12
B. Jordan Chen's department
C. Permission to enter other areas alone
D. The scheduled 10:00 meeting

Answers and explanations, page 135

Listen for the distinction

Read the welcome and waiting exchanges aloud. Keep V12, Jordan Chen in facilities, 10:00, and reception together.

Warmth and verification belong in the same welcome

A friendly reception need not rely on guessing who a visitor means. Explain the small ambiguity, use the appointment reference, and say what happens next. A waiting instruction should sound like a clear arrangement, not a personal suspicion or an invented promise about the host.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Welcome the visitor and identify the correct host

Complete the reception readback using the reference and the actual waiting arrangement.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

V12 / facilities / reception / Chen

01 **Receptionist:** The visitor reference is [1] _____.

02 **Visitor:** I am meeting Jordan [2] _____.

03 **Receptionist:** Your host works in [3] _____.

04 **Visitor:** I will wait at [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. V12 / **2.** Chen / **3.** facilities / **4.** reception

Why these answers fit, page 136

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two Jordans, one visitor reference". Taylor: "Please tell Jordan I've arrived, rather than just asking whether the meeting's still on." Nia: [missing response] Taylor: "Reception is fine. I don't need a different room; I just need Jordan to know where I am." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will keep the reception wait as the arrangement. No alternative room or entry route has been agreed, so I will not add one to the message.

B. Yes. The reference identifies your visit; it does not itself establish unaccompanied access. I will keep the next step clear while we contact the correct host.

C. I have not confirmed host availability yet. I can contact Jordan, but I do not want to promise an arrival time before I have that information.

D. Certainly. The arrival message will say Taylor is at reception for the ten o'clock meeting, reference V12. It will not describe this as a new booking request.

Answers and explanations, page 137

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Querying office supplies and delivery differences" and "Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Number of units requested on the order. Which term fits?

A. outstanding quantity

B. order reference

C. partial receipt

D. ordered quantity

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Time recorded for the arranged meeting. Which term fits?

A. identity match

B. reception

C. scheduled time

D. access clearance

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct version, missing permission". Kai: "I only need to read it. Please don't ask for editing rights on my behalf." Elena: [missing response] Kai: "While that's pending, should I leave the old attachment in the visitor email as a temporary fallback?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I'll make the access request specific: Kai needs to view the approved visitor guide, version 3, and the current link returns an error.

B. Then you need viewing access to version 3. I'll ask the document owner to resolve that separately from correcting my earlier message.

C. I need to verify it in the current guide. I won't guess a number; version 3 in the shared folder is the replacement source.

D. I shouldn't widen the permission scope on my own. I'll request access for you, not open the folder to an unrestricted audience.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two Jordans, one visitor reference". Taylor: "Could you repeat the full name and department once? I'd like to use the right surname." Nia: [missing response] Taylor: "Thank you. I'll stay here for the next update." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Welcome. May I check the visitor reference? We have two colleagues called Jordan, so I want to contact the right person before directing you anywhere.

B. I have not confirmed host availability yet. I can contact Jordan, but I do not want to promise an arrival time before I have that information.

C. Thank you. The appointment record names Jordan Chen in facilities. The other colleague is Jordan Patel in sales, so we have resolved that ambiguity.

D. Jordan Chen in facilities. Confirming the surname prevents confusion with Jordan Patel in sales. Your reference is V12, and you are waiting here at reception.

Answers and explanations, page 152

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / CLARIFYING TRAVEL OPTIONS AND BOOKING STATUS

Compare two supplied rail quotes, explain the conditional refund amount, and distinguish a comparison from an approved booking.

> **A higher fare with a conditional refund**
>
> Two fictional rail quotes cover the same trip. Option A costs $70 and is nonrefundable. Option B costs $90 and permits a refund before departure with a $10 deduction. Traveler Mira's meeting is not yet confirmed, and purchasing approval is still required. Assistant Ben must compare the quoted terms accurately without choosing for Mira, promising a full refund, or treating the discussion as authority to book.

People: Mira, Traveler; Ben, Administrative assistant.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is the price difference between the quotes?

A. $20
B. $10
C. $80
D. $160

2. Under the supplied terms, what refund does B permit before departure?

A. $70
B. No refund under any circumstances
C. $80
D. $90

3. What must happen before purchase?

A. Obtain the required purchasing approval
B. Treat this discussion as a booking
C. Assume the meeting is confirmed
D. Ignore the quoted conditions

Answers and explanations, page 138

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

rail quote
Stated price and conditions for a proposed train journey.

compare rail quotes

fare
Price charged for the specified travel.

state the fare

nonrefundable
Not permitting a refund under the stated quoted terms.

identify a nonrefundable fare

refundable
Permitting a refund subject to the applicable conditions.

qualify refundable

deduction
Amount subtracted from a payment or refund.

explain the deduction

before departure
Earlier than the stated leaving time.

preserve the before-departure condition

refund amount
Sum returned under the applicable refund terms.

calculate the refund amount

upfront cost
Amount paid at the time of purchase.

compare upfront costs

price difference
Amount by which one price exceeds another.

state the price difference

quoted terms
Conditions included in the supplied offer.

preserve the quoted terms

booking status
Current stage of a travel reservation or purchase.

clarify booking status

purchasing approval
Required permission to commit the organization to a purchase.

obtain purchasing approval

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

rail quote RAIL QUOTE

compare rail quotes

Keep the meaning precise: Stated price and conditions for a proposed train journey.

before departure BEFORE DEPARTURE

preserve the before-departure condition

Keep the meaning precise: Earlier than the stated leaving time.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

unconfirmed meeting

Meeting whose occurrence or arrangement is not yet settled.

identify the unconfirmed meeting

cash advance

Money provided before eligible expenses are settled, to be reconciled against the applicable claim.

reconcile the cash advance

refund eligibility

Whether the relevant conditions for a refund are met.

check refund eligibility

expense itemization

Separation of an expense into its component amounts and categories.

check expense itemization

travel authorization

Approval for travel within a defined scope.

distinguish travel authorization

itinerary

Planned sequence and details of travel.

check the itinerary

cancellation

Withdrawal from an existing booking under its terms.

distinguish cancellation from comparison

fare condition

Restriction or permission attached to a ticket price.

explain the fare condition

net refund

Amount returned after the stated deduction.

calculate the net refund

reservation

Arrangement holding travel space under specified terms.

verify a reservation

B Precision and professional shorthand / continued

ticket issuance

Creation or provision of the actual travel ticket.

distinguish ticket issuance

conditional comparison

Explanation that preserves the conditions affecting the alternatives.

give a conditional comparison

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

purchasing approval PURCHASING APPROVAL

obtain purchasing approval

Keep the meaning precise: Required permission to commit the organization to a purchase.

refund eligibility REFUND ELIGIBILITY

check refund eligibility

Keep the meaning precise: Whether the relevant conditions for a refund are met.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Define the comparison
Both quotes cover the same trip.

State option A
A costs $70 and is nonrefundable.

State option B
B costs $90.

Include the condition
B permits a refund before departure.

Include the deduction
The refund is reduced by $10.

Calculate the returned amount
Ninety minus ten leaves an $80 refund.

Compare upfront prices
B costs $20 more upfront.

Avoid a full-refund claim
Refundable does not mean the full $90 comes back.

Keep later terms open
No after-departure refund terms are supplied here.

Preserve meeting status
Your meeting is not confirmed yet.

Keep the choice separate
I can explain the options without choosing for you.

State the approval requirement
Purchasing approval is still required.

Avoid an accidental booking
This comparison is not a ticket purchase.

Distinguish the two amounts
The $20 premium and $10 deduction are different figures.

Request the next decision
Please confirm the authorized choice before any booking.

Close accurately
The prices and conditions are clear; the booking remains unapproved.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Include the condition
Useful wording: B permits a refund before departure.

Purpose: Include the deduction
Useful wording: The refund is reduced by $10.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which comparison is complete?

A. B is $90 with a guaranteed full refund anytime

B. A and B both cost $80

C. B costs only $10 more than A

D. A is $70 nonrefundable; B is $90 with an $80 refund before departure

2. What does the $10 represent?

A. The entire price of option A

B. The deduction from B's refund

C. The difference between the fares

D. A separate confirmed booking fee

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Permitting a refund subject to the applicable conditions. Which term fits?

A. price difference

B. travel authorization

C. refundable

D. cash advance

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher fare with a conditional refund". Mira: "For B, how much would actually come back? Refundable sounds like ninety, but there's a deduction." Ben: [missing response] Mira: "I nearly treated the ten dollars as the price difference. That's the amount retained from a refund, isn't it?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The net refund would be eighty dollars: ninety less ten. We should state the condition and the deduction together rather than simply describe B as refundable.

B. Exactly. The upfront cost is seventy for A or ninety for B. The ten-dollar deduction belongs to B's refund terms; it is not B's purchase price.

C. Right. The price difference is twenty dollars. Keeping those two figures separate prevents a misleading comparison, especially when you are explaining the options to the approver.

D. I will keep the booking status clear. This is a comparison, not a reservation or ticket purchase, and purchasing approval is still required before any commitment.

Answers and explanations, page 138

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A costs $70 and is nonrefundable under these quoted terms. B costs $90 and permits a refund before departure less $10, leaving $80. B costs $20 more upfront; the $10 deduction is not the price difference.

E Conversation

A higher fare with a conditional refund

A higher fare with a conditional refund

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

before departure / booking status / upfront cost / price difference / Purchasing approval / net refund / unconfirmed meeting / conditional comparison / fare / nonrefundable

01 **Mira:** My meeting isn't confirmed, so please don't book yet. Could you explain the two quotes for the same rail trip?

02 **Ben:** Yes. Option A has a [1] _____ of seventy dollars, and option B is ninety. The important difference is not only the price but also the refund conditions.

03 **Mira:** A says nonrefundable. Is that the condition we're using for the seventy-dollar option?

04 **Ben:** Correct. A is [2] _____ under these quoted terms. For B, a refund is permitted before departure, but ten dollars is deducted from the amount returned.

05 **Mira:** For B, how much would actually come back? Refundable sounds like ninety, but there's a deduction.

06 **Ben:** The [3] _____ would be eighty dollars: ninety less ten. We should state the condition and the deduction together rather than simply describe B as refundable.

07 **Mira:** I nearly treated the ten dollars as the price difference. That's the amount retained from a refund, isn't it?

08 **Ben:** Exactly. The [4] _____ is seventy for A or ninety for B. The ten-dollar deduction belongs to B's refund terms; it is not B's purchase price.

09 **Mira:** So B costs twenty more to buy, while the refund deduction is ten. Those aren't the same comparison.

10 **Ben:** Right. The [5] _____ is twenty dollars. Keeping those two figures separate prevents a misleading comparison, especially when you are explaining the options to the approver.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A higher fare with a conditional refund

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Mira:** What happens after departure? Does this quote actually say?

12 **Ben:** The supplied condition is [6] _____. We have no later refund terms here, so I cannot extend the eighty-dollar calculation to an after-departure cancellation.

13 **Mira:** Please keep this as a comparison. Asking about refunds isn't an instruction to buy a ticket.

14 **Ben:** I will keep the [7] _____ clear. This is a comparison, not a reservation or ticket purchase, and purchasing approval is still required before any commitment.

15 **Mira:** Can you give me a short summary for the approver without saying I've selected one?

16 **Ben:** Certainly. The [8] _____ is A at seventy, nonrefundable; B at ninety, with an eighty-dollar refund before departure after the ten-dollar deduction.

17 **Mira:** Add that the meeting's still unconfirmed, please. That's why I'm checking the conditions.

18 **Ben:** I will preserve the [9] _____ status alongside the quotes. The decision-maker should see the actual circumstances, not a message implying that the trip is already settled.

19 **Mira:** I'll get the choice and purchasing approval clarified. Nothing should be booked on the strength of this conversation.

20 **Ben:** Agreed. [10] _____ remains outstanding. I will not issue a ticket or record an authorized choice until the required confirmation is available.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. fare / **2.** nonrefundable / **3.** net refund / **4.** upfront cost / **5.** price difference / **6.** before departure / **7.** booking status / **8.** conditional comparison / **9.** unconfirmed meeting / **10.** Purchasing approval

Why these answers fit, page 139

F Check accuracy and scope

A higher fare with a conditional refund

Return to the case

Two fictional rail quotes cover the same trip. Option A costs $70 and is nonrefundable. Option B costs $90 and permits a refund before departure with a $10 deduction. Traveler Mira's meeting is not yet confirmed, and purchasing approval is still required. Assistant Ben must compare the quoted terms accurately without choosing for Mira, promising a full refund, or treating the discussion as authority to book.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which claim is unsupported?

A. Approval is required

B. B is refundable after departure without restrictions

C. B costs $90

D. A costs $70

2. Which handoff is ready for the approver?

A. B reserved with a full refund guaranteed after departure

B. Both quotes with conditions, meeting unconfirmed, no purchase approved

C. B selected because its refund makes it cheaper to buy

D. A booked because it has the lower upfront price

Answers and explanations, page 141

Listen for the distinction

Read both quotes aloud: A $70 nonrefundable; B $90, refund $80 before departure. Then read the separate approval requirement.

Explain the condition as carefully as the price

The word refundable can hide a deadline and a deduction. State the upfront price, the condition, and the resulting amount together. A useful comparison helps an authorized decision without turning the assistant's explanation into a booking or financial recommendation.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

State the price and the refund condition

Complete the comparison using the supplied fares and terms. Do not turn the comparison into a booking.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

approval / eighty / seventy / ninety

01 **Assistant:** Option A costs [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Traveler:** Option B costs [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Assistant:** Before departure, B permits an [3] _____-dollar refund.

04 **Traveler:** Purchasing [4] _____ is still required.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. seventy / **2.** ninety / **3.** eighty / **4.** approval

Why these answers fit, page 141

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher fare with a conditional refund". Mira: "Please keep this as a comparison. Asking about refunds isn't an instruction to buy a ticket." Ben: [missing response] Mira: "Can you give me a short summary for the approver without saying I've selected one?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will keep the booking status clear. This is a comparison, not a reservation or ticket purchase, and purchasing approval is still required before any commitment.

B. Exactly. The upfront cost is seventy for A or ninety for B. The ten-dollar deduction belongs to B's refund terms; it is not B's purchase price.

C. The net refund would be eighty dollars: ninety less ten. We should state the condition and the deduction together rather than simply describe B as refundable.

D. Right. The price difference is twenty dollars. Keeping those two figures separate prevents a misleading comparison, especially when you are explaining the options to the approver.

Answers and explanations, page 142

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / PRIORITIZING WORK AND HANDING OVER COVERAGE

Explain a capacity conflict with concrete timings and ask the manager to select a priority or change a deadline.

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

At 10:00, assistant Rosa has a visitor list due at 10:30 and a room pack due at 11:00. Each requires thirty minutes. Manager Ellis requests a new twenty-minute spreadsheet check by 10:20. No colleague is available to help. Rosa must explain the conflict and ask Ellis to choose priorities or adjust a deadline. The case ends with that decision still needed; Rosa cannot truthfully promise all three original deadlines.

People: Rosa, Administrative assistant; Ellis, Manager.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is due at 10:30?

A. The visitor list
B. The room pack
C. The new spreadsheet check
D. An already completed handover

2. How much work is requested in total?

A. Sixty minutes
B. Thirty minutes
C. Twenty minutes
D. Eighty minutes

3. What should Rosa ask Ellis to do?

A. Treat the durations as zero
B. Choose priorities or adjust a deadline
C. Assume all three will be on time
D. Assign the work to an unavailable colleague

Answers and explanations, page 143

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

workload
Amount of work assigned or awaiting completion.

explain the workload

capacity
Available ability or time to carry out work.

state the capacity limit

priority decision
Choice about which task takes precedence.

request a priority decision

deadline
Latest required completion time for a task.

clarify the deadline

task duration
Time needed to perform the stated work.

specify task duration

visitor list
Record of expected visitors for the relevant arrangement.

prepare the visitor list

room pack
Set of materials prepared for use in the meeting room.

assemble the room pack

spreadsheet check
Review of the specified spreadsheet information.

perform the spreadsheet check

competing request
New demand that conflicts with existing commitments.

identify the competing request

time window
Period within which work must be performed.

define the available time window

sequence
Order in which tasks are carried out.

agree the task sequence

trade-off
Consequence of choosing one priority at the expense of another.

explain the trade-off

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

workload WORKLOAD

explain the workload

Keep the meaning precise: Amount of work assigned or awaiting completion.

visitor list VISITOR LIST

prepare the visitor list

Keep the meaning precise: Record of expected visitors for the relevant arrangement.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

revised deadline

Newly agreed completion requirement.

obtain a revised deadline

displaced task

Work moved later because another task takes its place.

identify the displaced task

coverage

Availability of another person to handle work during the relevant period.

confirm coverage

delegation

Assignment of a task to someone with the relevant availability and authority.

avoid unsupported delegation

commitment

Promise to complete a defined action under stated conditions.

make a realistic commitment

overcommitment

Acceptance of more work than the available capacity permits.

avoid overcommitment

schedule impact

Effect of a change on task timing.

explain the schedule impact

earliest finish

First possible completion time under the stated sequence and durations.

calculate the earliest finish

existing obligation

Task already required before the new request arrives.

preserve existing obligations

reprioritization

Change to the order or importance of assigned work.

request reprioritization

handover coverage

Confirmed support for taking over specified work.

verify handover coverage

decision readback

Repetition of the chosen priority and its consequences.

prepare a decision readback

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

trade-off TRADE-OFF

explain the trade-off

Keep the meaning precise: Consequence of choosing one priority at the expense of another.

commitment COMMITMENT

make a realistic commitment

Keep the meaning precise: Promise to complete a defined action under stated conditions.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the request

I understand you need the spreadsheet check by 10:20.

State the first deadline

The visitor list is due at 10:30.

Give the durations

Each existing task needs thirty minutes.

Show the capacity conflict

That is eighty minutes of work between 10:00 and 11:00.

Keep consequences conditional

That sequence would also move the room pack to 11:20.

Ask for a decision

Which task should take priority?

Preserve prior commitments

I need to know which existing commitment should move.

Request explicit agreement

Please confirm the revised priority or deadline.

Name the existing work

The visitor list and room pack are already due this morning.

State the second deadline

The room pack is due at 11:00.

Add the new demand

The spreadsheet check adds twenty minutes.

State the immediate consequence

If I do the check first, the visitor list cannot finish before 10:50.

Avoid imaginary help

No colleague is available to take over a task.

Offer the relevant alternative

Can one of the deadlines be adjusted?

Avoid vague assent

I cannot confirm all three original deadlines.

Close without pretending

The schedule change still needs your decision.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the second deadline
Useful wording: The room pack is due at 11:00.

Purpose: Give the durations
Useful wording: Each existing task needs thirty minutes.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. If Rosa does the check first, when can the visitor list finish at the earliest?

A. 11:20
B. 10:50
C. 10:20
D. 10:30

2. If that sequence continues with the room pack, when does it finish?

A. 11:20
B. 10:50
C. 11:00
D. 10:20

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Latest required completion time for a task. Which term fits?

A. existing obligation
B. coverage
C. deadline
D. competing request

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window". Ellis: "If you start the spreadsheet right away, it finishes at ten twenty. Where does that leave the list?" Rosa: [missing response] Ellis: "Could you do the list faster to catch up? I'm trying to avoid moving the visitor deadline." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. That's the schedule impact of spreadsheet, list, then room pack. Those finish times aren't approved deadline changes yet.

B. It uses twenty minutes of the time window. With the list next, its earliest finish becomes ten fifty, not ten thirty.

C. Thank you. Any revised deadline needs explicit agreement. Until then, the list is still due at ten thirty and the pack at eleven.

D. The supplied task duration is thirty minutes. I can't responsibly promise a shorter one without a basis for it.

Answers and explanations, page 143

> **One useful distinction**
>
> At 10:00, the original two tasks already require the full sixty minutes until 11:00. The new check adds twenty minutes and is due at 10:20. Doing it first moves the earliest visitor-list finish to 10:50, beyond its 10:30 deadline.

E Conversation

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

decision readback / priority decision / schedule impact / overcommitment / competing request / time window / visitor list / revised deadline / coverage / task duration

01 **Ellis:** Could you check this spreadsheet by ten twenty? It needs twenty minutes, and I'd like it ready for the next discussion.

02 **Rosa:** Before I accept the [1] _____, can we look at what's already due? It's ten now, and the existing tasks fill the next hour.

03 **Ellis:** I knew about the room pack. What's the other deadline?

04 **Rosa:** The [2] _____ is due at ten thirty and needs thirty minutes. The room pack also takes thirty minutes and is due at eleven.

05 **Ellis:** If you start the spreadsheet right away, it finishes at ten twenty. Where does that leave the list?

06 **Rosa:** It uses twenty minutes of the [3] _____. With the list next, its earliest finish becomes ten fifty, not ten thirty.

07 **Ellis:** Could you do the list faster to catch up? I'm trying to avoid moving the visitor deadline.

08 **Rosa:** The supplied [4] _____ is thirty minutes. I can't responsibly promise a shorter one without a basis for it.

09 **Ellis:** Then the room pack would follow the list and finish at eleven twenty. That's late as well.

10 **Rosa:** Yes. That's the [5] _____ of spreadsheet, list, then room pack. Those finish times aren't approved deadline changes yet.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ellis:** Could someone else assemble the pack while you work on the check?

12 **Rosa:** There's no available [6] _____. No colleague is free, so a handover won't solve this particular conflict.

13 **Ellis:** All three feel urgent, but I see that saying urgent doesn't create another twenty minutes.

14 **Rosa:** I need a [7] _____. Should the spreadsheet come first, and if so, which existing commitment may move?

15 **Ellis:** Let me check which deadline has flexibility before answering. I don't want you to drop the list without me realizing.

16 **Rosa:** Thank you. Any [8] _____ needs explicit agreement. Until then, the list is still due at ten thirty and the pack at eleven.

17 **Ellis:** Don't treat the new request as fully accepted yet. I still need to choose what changes.

18 **Rosa:** Understood. That avoids [9] _____: eighty minutes of work can't fit into the available sixty while preserving these original deadlines.

19 **Ellis:** Keep the durations and consequences in front of us. I'll use those to make the choice.

20 **Rosa:** Once you decide, I'll give a [10] _____ of the agreed order and any changed deadline. For now, the priority choice is still outstanding.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. competing request / **2.** visitor list / **3.** time window / **4.** task duration / **5.** schedule impact / **6.** coverage / **7.** priority decision / **8.** revised deadline / **9.** overcommitment / **10.** decision readback

Why these answers fit, page 144

F Check accuracy and scope

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

Return to the case

At 10:00, assistant Rosa has a visitor list due at 10:30 and a room pack due at 11:00. Each requires thirty minutes. Manager Ellis requests a new twenty-minute spreadsheet check by 10:20. No colleague is available to help. Rosa must explain the conflict and ask Ellis to choose priorities or adjust a deadline. The case ends with that decision still needed; Rosa cannot truthfully promise all three original deadlines.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which response is professionally clear?

A. I need a priority choice or an adjusted deadline because these tasks require eighty minutes
B. I will somehow meet every original deadline
C. Another colleague will do it despite being unavailable
D. The visitor list no longer matters without asking

2. What remains unresolved at the end of the case?

A. Whether a colleague is available
B. The original visitor-list deadline
C. Which priority or deadline Ellis will change
D. The stated task durations

Answers and explanations, page 146

Listen for the distinction

Read the proposed sequence aloud with finish times 10:20, 10:50, and 11:20. Identify them as consequences, not approved deadlines, using Rosa's supplied wording.

Make the trade-off concrete, not personal

Saying that you are busy does not show which commitment will move. State the existing deadlines and task durations, then ask for a priority decision. Respectful pushback gives the manager an accurate choice without silently accepting an impossible schedule or delegating to an unavailable colleague.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Ask for a realistic priority decision

Complete the workload readback. Keep calculated finish times separate from approved deadline changes.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

10:50 / 10:30 / eighty / decision

01 **Assistant:** The three tasks require [1] _____ minutes in total.

02 **Manager:** The visitor list is originally due at [2] _____.

03 **Assistant:** If the check comes first, the list finishes no earlier than [3] _____.

04 **Manager:** A priority [4] _____ is still needed.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. eighty / **2.** 10:30 / **3.** 10:50 / **4.** decision

Why these answers fit, page 146

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window". Ellis: "All three feel urgent, but I see that saying urgent doesn't create another twenty minutes." Rosa: [missing response] Ellis: "Let me check which deadline has flexibility before answering. I don't want you to drop the list without me realizing." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. That's the schedule impact of spreadsheet, list, then room pack. Those finish times aren't approved deadline changes yet.

B. The supplied task duration is thirty minutes. I can't responsibly promise a shorter one without a basis for it.

C. I need a priority decision. Should the spreadsheet come first, and if so, which existing commitment may move?

D. Understood. That avoids overcommitment: eighty minutes of work can't fit into the available sixty while preserving these original deadlines.

Answers and explanations, page 147

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Clarifying travel options and booking status" and "Prioritizing work and handing over coverage". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Not permitting a refund under the stated quoted terms. Which term fits?

A. nonrefundable
B. itinerary
C. net refund
D. upfront cost

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Review of the specified spreadsheet information. Which term fits?

A. schedule impact
B. workload
C. spreadsheet check
D. revised deadline

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Two Jordans, one visitor reference". Taylor: "Could I wait near the facilities office instead, so I'm easier to find?" Nia: [missing response] Taylor: "Understood. I thought the meeting confirmation might be enough to go through." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Please remain in the waiting area here for now. You have not been cleared to enter the other areas alone, and I do not want to send you beyond the current arrangement.
B. You are welcome. I will coordinate the visitor handoff once the host response is available. For now, the correct host has been identified and the waiting instruction is clear.
C. I will keep the reception wait as the arrangement. No alternative room or entry route has been agreed, so I will not add one to the message.
D. Certainly. The arrival message will say Taylor is at reception for the ten o'clock meeting, reference V12. It will not describe this as a new booking request.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window". Ellis: "Don't treat the new request as fully accepted yet. I still need to choose what changes." Rosa: [missing response] Ellis: "Keep the durations and consequences in front of us. I'll use those to make the choice." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The supplied task duration is thirty minutes. I can't responsibly promise a shorter one without a basis for it.

B. Yes. That's the schedule impact of spreadsheet, list, then room pack. Those finish times aren't approved deadline changes yet.

C. I need a priority decision. Should the spreadsheet come first, and if so, which existing commitment may move?

D. Understood. That avoids overcommitment: eighty minutes of work can't fit into the available sixty while preserving these original deadlines.

Answers and explanations, page 154

Language for the next case

Receipts are not the reimbursement

payment method

The hotel was paid directly by the company, while the meal and rail fare were employee-paid; adding all receipts does not give the amount owed to Mira.

Ben: We need to separate the payment method first. The two-hundred-sixty-four-dollar hotel bill was already paid directly by the company, not by you.

company-paid expense

The hotel remains a documented trip cost but is excluded from employee reimbursement because the company has already paid it directly.

Ben: Exactly. Keep it as a company-paid expense. Supporting the trip record and reimbursing you are different purposes; the receipt shouldn't disappear.

itemization

Itemization separates the meal receipt's forty-eight-dollar eligible share from its twenty-dollar personal share; the whole sixty-eight is not reimbursable in this case.

Ben: Use the stated itemization. Forty-eight goes into the eligible employee-paid amount; the policy excludes the twenty.

out-of-pocket expenses

The eligible employee-paid amounts are forty-eight for the meal and forty-two for rail, totaling ninety; the company-paid hotel is not added.

Ben: Yes. Those are the out-of-pocket expenses relevant to this calculation: forty-eight plus forty-two. Don't add the meal's personal share back into that subtotal.

cash advance

The fifty-dollar advance is money already provided for the trip; subtract it once from ninety dollars of eligible employee-paid costs to obtain forty due.

Ben: Correct. The cash advance is applied once. It's not another expense and it doesn't need to be subtracted from every receipt separately.

net reimbursement

Ninety eligible employee-paid dollars less the fifty-dollar advance leaves forty dollars due to the employee, subject to the pending approval and payment.

Ben: Right. The calculated net reimbursement is forty. Calculation, approval, and transfer of money are three different stages.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Receipts are not the reimbursement

Fictional trip, all amounts in dollars. Hotel receipt $264, already paid directly by the company. Employee paid a $68 meal receipt: $48 eligible business share and $20 excluded personal share under this case's policy. Employee also paid eligible rail fare $42 and received a $50 cash advance. Figures include all applicable charges; no extra tax, fee, or currency conversion. Approval and payment are pending.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

payment method / out-of-pocket expenses / itemization / cash advance / net reimbursement / company-paid expense

01 **Mira:** The receipts total three hundred seventy-four dollars. I took off the fifty-dollar advance and put three hundred twenty-four as the amount the company owes me.

02 **Ben:** We need to separate the [1] _____ first. The two-hundred-sixty-four-dollar hotel bill was already paid directly by the company, not by you.

03 **Mira:** So the hotel receipt belongs with the trip record, but it isn't another two hundred sixty-four dollars to pay into my account.

04 **Ben:** Exactly. Keep it as a [2] _____. Supporting the trip record and reimbursing you are different purposes; the receipt shouldn't disappear.

05 **Mira:** I paid the meal bill myself. It's sixty-eight in total, but the worksheet marks twenty as my personal share and forty-eight as eligible.

06 **Ben:** Use the stated [3] _____. Forty-eight goes into the eligible employee-paid amount; the policy excludes the twenty.

Conversation / continued

07 **Mira:** And the forty-two-dollar rail ticket is fully eligible here. That gives me ninety dollars of eligible costs I paid, before the advance.

08 **Ben:** Yes. Those are the [4] _____ relevant to this calculation: forty-eight plus forty-two. Don't add the meal's personal share back into that subtotal.

09 **Mira:** Now I subtract the fifty dollars I already received. That leaves forty, not three hundred twenty-four or ninety.

10 **Ben:** Correct. The [5] _____ is applied once. It's not another expense and it doesn't need to be subtracted from every receipt separately.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Receipts are not the reimbursement

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Mira:** Then the amount due to me is forty dollars, assuming this claim is approved. I shouldn't describe it as already paid.

12 **Ben:** Right. The calculated [6] _____ is forty. Calculation, approval, and transfer of money are three different stages.

13 **Mira:** I still want the approver to see why the meal receipt says sixty-eight when the eligible line says forty-eight. Will that look like a mismatch?

14 **Ben:** Not if the split is clear. Retain the total receipt and show forty-eight business plus twenty personal. The two parts reconcile to sixty-eight.

15 **Mira:** And I shouldn't enter another tax allowance because these figures already include all the applicable charges supplied in this example.

16 **Ben:** Exactly. No extra tax, fee, or exchange adjustment has been specified. Adding one would change the case instead of checking it.

17 **Mira:** What if the advance had been a hundred, with the same ninety dollars of eligible employee-paid costs? Would the company still owe me ten?

18 **Ben:** The direction would reverse: ten would remain to return under the case's settlement rule. An excess advance isn't another reimbursement due to you.

19 **Mira:** I'll submit the hotel as company-paid, retain the meal split, include the rail receipt, and show ninety less fifty equals forty due.

20 **Ben:** That gives the approver a traceable reconciliation. Keep the personal exclusion and advance visible, and leave approval and payment marked pending until they're actually confirmed.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. payment method / **2.** company-paid expense / **3.** itemization / **4.** out-of-pocket expenses / **5.** cash advance / **6.** net reimbursement

Why these answers fit, page 156

Keep the payer and advance visible

Another fictional trip has $120 of eligible employee-paid expenses, plus a separate $15 personal expense excluded by policy. The company directly paid $200 of additional travel costs. The employee received an $80 advance. No other amounts apply; approval is pending.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

120 / 80 / 40 / pending

01 **Traveler:** Eligible employee-paid costs are [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Assistant:** The advance to subtract once is [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Traveler:** The calculated amount due to me is [3] _____ dollars.

04 **Assistant:** The approval status is still [4] _____ .

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 120 / **2.** 80 / **3.** 40 / **4.** pending

Why these answers fit, page 156

Keep the distinction audible

Reconcile an expense claim without paying company-funded or personal costs twice.

Language for the next case

Check the people behind the rows

recipient identifier

The supplied IDs distinguish people; the owner confirms that the repeated A02 row is an identical duplicate, leaving five distinct people in six rows.

Kai: Start with the recipient identifier, not the row count. A02 is duplicated; those two rows belong to one person, not two attendees.

recipient filter

The confirmed-only selection includes A01, A02, and A03 once each; declined A04 and pending A05 are excluded from this particular mailing.

Kai: Then the recipient filter leaves three letters after resolving the duplicate. It doesn't leave five, six, or four with A02 counted twice.

leading zeros

The verified test code is 00123; dropping its leading zeros changes the identifier, and the prepared text value must retain all five characters.

Kai: No. Those leading zeros belong to the code. Preserve it as text and check the merged result against the source, rather than accepting a shortened identifier.

duplicate record

A02 and A03 are different people sharing an address; only the repeated A02 row is confirmed as an identical duplicate in this case.

Kai: No. A shared address isn't a duplicate record by itself. They're different people and each needs a separate letter if included in the approved mailing.

data source

The underlying contact data remains distinct from the subset selected for this mailing; excluding someone from the current run does not require deleting their source record.

Kai: Correct. The data source still contains their statuses. We're selecting a mailing audience, not erasing people or changing their replies.

merge field

A merge field inserts a particular source value into the template; the name, address, and code must all come from the intended recipient's record.

Kai: Good. Also verify the merge field mapping. A correct greeting paired with another person's address would still produce the wrong letter.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Check the people behind the rows

Fictional printed confirmation mailing: six rows, IDs A01, A02, A02, A03, A04, A05. The owner confirms the two A02 rows are an identical duplicate, not separate people. A01-A03 are confirmed; A04 declined; A05 is pending. Send one letter per confirmed person only. A02 and A03 share a postal address but are different people. A01's verified test postal code is 00123. Nothing has been dispatched.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

duplicate record / leading zeros / data source / recipient filter / merge field / recipient identifier

01 **Elena:** The sheet has six rows, so I expected six letters. But A02 appears twice, and two different names have the same postal address.

02 **Kai:** Start with the [1] _____, not the row count. A02 is duplicated; those two rows belong to one person, not two attendees.

03 **Elena:** That leaves five distinct people. Should I also combine A02 and A03 because their address matches?

04 **Kai:** No. A shared address isn't a [2] _____ by itself. They're different people and each needs a separate letter if included in the approved mailing.

05 **Elena:** The mailing is for confirmed attendees only. A01, A02, and A03 are confirmed; A04 declined and A05 hasn't answered.

06 **Kai:** Then the [3] _____ leaves three letters after resolving the duplicate. It doesn't leave five, six, or four with A02 counted twice.

Conversation / continued

07 **Elena:** I'll exclude the declined and pending records from this run. That doesn't mean deleting their records from the office's main list.

08 **Kai:** Correct. The [4] _____ still contains their statuses. We're selecting a mailing audience, not erasing people or changing their replies.

09 **Elena:** The preview shows A01's postal code as 123, but your verified source says 00123. Can I just ignore the missing zeros?

10 **Kai:** No. Those [5] _____ belong to the code. Preserve it as text and check the merged result against the source, rather than accepting a shortened identifier.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Check the people behind the rows

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Elena:** Changing the cell format now wouldn't recover characters already lost from an imported number. I'll check the original source value rather than invent padding.

12 **Kai:** Good. Also verify the [6] _____ mapping. A correct greeting paired with another person's address would still produce the wrong letter.

13 **Elena:** I'll compare all three complete previews, not only the template. The shared address makes it particularly important to check the individual names.

14 **Kai:** Yes. A template can look right before actual values are inserted. Check each selected record's name, address, code, and confirmed status together.

15 **Elena:** The tool offers a duplicate finder based on names. Should its suggestion override your confirmed IDs?

16 **Kai:** No. A suggested match needs review against the record meaning. Our known duplicate is A02; matching names or addresses alone doesn't prove identical people.

17 **Elena:** So the check is three letters: A01, A02, A03. One A02, no A04 or A05, and no combined household letter.

18 **Kai:** That's the required selection. Keep the source correction traceable and confirm the final output count against those three identifiers.

19 **Elena:** I'll keep dispatch pending while we review the corrected previews. Generating a file hasn't put anything in the post.

20 **Kai:** Exactly. Record the list review and final output separately from dispatch. The result should be three accurate individual confirmations, not simply six copies because there were six rows.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. recipient identifier / **2.** duplicate record / **3.** recipient filter / **4.** data source / **5.** leading zeros / **6.** merge field

Why these answers fit, page 158

Count selected people, not rows

A new fictional list has B01, B02, B02, B03, B04. The owner confirms identical B02 duplication. B01 and B03 are confirmed, B02 pending, B04 declined. Send one letter per confirmed person only. B01's verified test postal code is 00456; the preview currently shows 456. No dispatch has occurred.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

pending / 00456 / two / unconfirmed

01 **Assistant:** The selected mailing should contain [1] _____ letters.

02 **Owner:** B02 remains [2] _____, not confirmed.

03 **Assistant:** B01's code must read [3] _____ in the output.

04 **Owner:** Dispatch is [4] _____ .

CHECK THE GAPS

1. two / **2.** pending / **3.** 00456 / **4.** unconfirmed

Why these answers fit, page 158

Keep the distinction audible

Review a personalized mailing by recipient identity, selection rules, and field accuracy.

Language for the next case

Pages, sheets, and finished copies

booklet imposition

Booklet imposition arranges the document pages for folding; this brief puts four finished pages on each physical A3 sheet, not one page per sheet.

Farah: Not for this booklet imposition. Six hundred is the number of finished document pages across thirty booklets, not the number of A3 sheets.

sheet count

Thirty finished booklets at five physical sheets each require one hundred fifty A3 sheets; duplex use is already included in the four-pages-per-sheet calculation.

Farah: Correct. The sheet count already includes the two-sided layout. Dividing by two again would count the same paper saving twice.

physical proof

A complete physical proof uses all five sheets of the twenty-page booklet; two separate proofs therefore need ten sheets, not two.

Farah: Yes. Each physical proof uses five sheets. Two proofs add ten, giving one hundred sixty sheets under this exact brief.

Duplex printing

Duplex means both sides are printed; the supplied two-pages-per-side layout gives four document pages across a physical sheet, not eight.

Farah: Right. Duplex printing uses both sides here. Twenty pages divided by four gives five A3 sheets for each complete booklet.

finished size

The booklet's finished page size is A4 after the A3 sheets are folded; A3 is the input sheet size, not the finished booklet-page size.

Farah: Exactly. Also, the finished size is A4. A3 describes the paper going into this job, not the size of each finished page.

production quantity

The order requires thirty finished distribution copies in addition to two proofs; the proofs must not reduce the thirty-copy delivery quantity.

Farah: Right. The production quantity remains thirty. We prepare the proofs first, but the full run waits for approval.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Pages, sheets, and finished copies

Fictional print brief: 20 A4 pages including all covers, printed as folded A3 booklets. Each physical A3 sheet carries two A4 pages per side, four pages across both sides. Need 30 finished booklets plus two separate complete physical proofs. All use the same paper; no extra covers, waste allowance, or spare copies. Full production must await proof approval. Price and delivery date are not supplied.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

physical proof / Duplex printing / finished size / booklet imposition / sheet count / production quantity

01 **Sam:** I wrote thirty copies of twenty pages, so six hundred sheets. Then I added two sheets for the proofs. Is that the right paper count?

02 **Farah:** Not for this [1] _____. Six hundred is the number of finished document pages across thirty booklets, not the number of A3 sheets.

03 **Sam:** Each A3 sheet has two A4 pages on the front and two on the back. That makes four document pages per physical sheet.

04 **Farah:** Right. [2] _____ uses both sides here. Twenty pages divided by four gives five A3 sheets for each complete booklet.

05 **Sam:** Then thirty finished copies require a hundred fifty sheets, before the separate proofs. I shouldn't halve that again just because they're double-sided.

06 **Farah:** Correct. The [3] _____ already includes the two-sided layout. Dividing by two again would count the same paper saving twice.

Conversation / continued

07 **Sam:** The brief includes covers within the twenty pages. So I don't add another cover sheet to every copy.

08 **Farah:** Exactly. Also, the [4] _____ is A4. A3 describes the paper going into this job, not the size of each finished page.

09 **Sam:** What about the two proofs? I treated them as two extra pages, but you need two complete assembled booklets for review.

10 **Farah:** Yes. Each [5] _____ uses five sheets. Two proofs add ten, giving one hundred sixty sheets under this exact brief.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Pages, sheets, and finished copies

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Sam:** That's thirty copies for distribution plus two separate proofs, not thirty copies with the proofs taken out of the delivery quantity.

12 **Farah:** Right. The [6] _____ remains thirty. We prepare the proofs first, but the full run waits for approval.

13 **Sam:** If I say the file is ready, that doesn't mean you have permission to print all thirty before anyone checks the folded result.

14 **Farah:** Correct. A ready file and an approved proof are different statuses. We need to check the assembled page order, orientation, and content before release.

15 **Sam:** The file is in normal reading order. Should I manually rearrange its pages to look like the outer and inner print sheets?

16 **Farah:** Don't assume that. Confirm the print-room input requirement. Applying booklet arrangement twice can scramble the sequence; the supplied count alone doesn't establish the correct production file.

17 **Sam:** And one hundred sixty is an exact-use calculation. It doesn't include test waste, damaged sheets, or an extra stock allowance.

18 **Farah:** Yes. Any allowance would need to be stated separately. We haven't supplied one, and we also haven't agreed a price or delivery date.

19 **Sam:** I'll revise the brief: twenty pages including covers, A4 finished, A3 duplex booklet layout, thirty distribution copies plus two full proofs.

20 **Farah:** Add five sheets per booklet and one hundred sixty for the stated quantities. Keep full production pending proof approval, with price and delivery still to confirm.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. booklet imposition / **2.** Duplex printing / **3.** sheet count / **4.** finished size / **5.** physical proof / **6.** production quantity

Why these answers fit, page 160

Count another booklet order

A fictional 24-page booklet, covers included, uses four finished pages per physical sheet. Need 18 distribution copies plus one separate complete proof. No waste, spare copies, or extra covers. The proof has not been approved.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

108 / pending / six / 114

01 **Coordinator:** Each booklet requires [1] _____ sheets.

02 **Print lead:** The eighteen distribution copies use [2] _____ sheets.

03 **Coordinator:** Including the complete proof, exact usage is [3] _____ sheets.

04 **Print lead:** Full production remains [4] _____ .

CHECK THE GAPS

1. six / **2.** 108 / **3.** 114 / **4.** pending

Why these answers fit, page 160

Keep the distinction audible

Specify a booklet order without confusing page count, paper count, proofs, and approval.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is missing from the initial request?

D. Whose local time 3:00 refers to

The request supplies a clock time but does not identify the intended office reference.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. What equivalence is supplied for this date?

C. 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office

The brief explicitly gives the date-specific relationship between the two local times.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What should happen before invitations are sent?

A. Confirm the intended time reference

Clarifying the intended office time is necessary before sending the invitation.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which clarification is best?

C. Does 3:00 refer to your office or the other office?

The question directly resolves the missing location reference for the requested time.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which entry preserves the clarified meeting without adding missing details?

B. One meeting: Maya's office 3:00, other office noon; duration pending

The supplied equivalence names one moment, but neither a duration nor an accepted invitation has been established.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Different clock display representing the same moment elsewhere. Which term fits?

D. equivalent time

A Not here. attendee: Person invited to or participating in a meeting. The usual combination is "confirm the attendee list".

B Not here. duration: Length of time an event is intended to last. The usual combination is "request the meeting duration".

C Not here. calendar entry: Event recorded in a scheduling system. The usual combination is "check the calendar entry".

D Correct. equivalent time: Different clock display representing the same moment elsewhere. The usual combination is "read back the equivalent time".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Three o'clock in whose office?". Maya: "Yes, three here and noon there. Please don't put three next to both office names in the message." Arun: [missing response] Maya: "Is that enough to send it? The free slots were what I checked before asking you." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Agreed. There are two local time displays for one meeting, not two meetings at the same clock time.

A Correct. This is Arun's response in turn 6. It connects Maya's preceding point with Maya's follow-up. Local time refers to each office's own clock display for the same meeting moment.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Maya says: "Could you set up three o'clock with the other office? Both calendars look open, so I'd like to get it arranged." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Maya says: "Is that enough to send it? The free slots were what I checked before asking you." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Maya says: "Let me check: three in my office, noon in theirs, on the date we're discussing. Nothing sent yet." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. time reference

Turn 2. Time reference identifies which office's clock gives the requested three o'clock its intended meaning.

2. equivalent time

Turn 4. Equivalent time is noon in the other office when Maya's office shows three.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. local time

Turn 6. Local time refers to each office's own clock display for the same meeting moment.

4. calendar availability

Turn 8. Calendar availability confirms an open slot but does not supply the missing duration or location.

5. meeting request

Turn 10. Meeting request remains a proposal whose details must be confirmed before an invitation is issued.

6. date-specific

Turn 12. Date-specific limits the supplied equivalence to the fictional meeting date rather than every future meeting.

7. Acceptance

Turn 14. Acceptance is an attendee's agreement to an invitation, distinct from a calendar appearing open.

8. invitation

Turn 16. Invitation is the attendance request that should contain confirmed scheduling details without assuming prior acceptance.

9. schedule readback

Turn 18. Schedule readback repeats both equivalent office times and preserves that invitations have not yet been sent.

10. Recurrence

Turn 20. Recurrence describes a repeating schedule, which Maya has not authorized in the current request.

Return to the conversation, page 10

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What does calendar availability establish?

D. The relevant slot is open, not that the intended time is confirmed

Availability concerns the calendar slot rather than intention, duration, or acceptance.

Return to the exercise, page 12

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which detail must not be invented?

C. A one-hour meeting duration

The brief provides no duration from which a one-hour meeting could be established.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F / Guided speaking

1. time

Assistant: Whose local time do you mean?

Turn 1. Time is the ambiguous reference that must be attached to an office.

2. noon

Colleague: Three in my office equals noon at the other office.

Turn 2. Noon is the supplied equivalent for the fictional meeting date.

3. open

Assistant: Both calendars are open at that time.

Turn 3. Open describes availability without establishing that an invitation has been accepted.

4. sending

Colleague: Confirm the remaining details before sending.

Turn 4. Sending must follow clarification rather than precede the missing details.

Return to the conversation, page 13

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Three o'clock in whose office?". Maya: "Understood. Also, seeing a free slot doesn't mean their colleagues have agreed to attend, does it?" Arun: [missing response] Maya: "Please keep the eventual message as a request, then. I don't want it to sound as though attendance is already settled." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. No. Acceptance is a separate response. We shouldn't say they've agreed just because their calendars appear open.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Maya says: "Is that enough to send it? The free slots were what I checked before asking you." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Maya says: "Please keep the eventual message as a request, then. I don't want it to sound as though attendance is already settled." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Maya says: "We may need another meeting with them later. Can I just use the same three-hour difference every time?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Arun's response in turn 14. It connects Maya's preceding point with Maya's follow-up. Acceptance is an attendee's agreement to an invitation, distinct from a calendar appearing open.

Return to the exercise, page 13

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which team does Lena need?

A. Facilities

The call concerns delivery D18 and is explicitly for facilities.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A2. What is the facilities extension?

D. 214

The supplied internal telephone extension for facilities is 214.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A3. How should before 4:00 be recorded?

D. A requested callback deadline

Lena requests the callback, but the team's availability is unknown.

Return to the exercise, page 14

D / Response choices

D1. Which message is accurate?

D. Lena Park requests facilities about delivery D18, callback before 4:00

The correct message preserves the caller, team, reference, and requested timing.

Return to the exercise, page 18

D2. Which response overpromises?

B. They will definitely call before four

The team's unknown availability cannot support a definite callback promise.

Return to the exercise, page 18

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Internal telephone number used within an organization. Which term fits?

D. extension

A Not here. recipient availability: Whether the intended person or team can respond. The usual combination is "check recipient availability".

B Not here. call log: Record of telephone contacts and their relevant details. The usual combination is "update the call log".

C Not here. callback request: Request for someone to return a telephone call. The usual combination is "relay a callback request".

D Correct. extension: Internal telephone number used within an organization. The usual combination is "confirm the extension".

Return to the exercise, page 18

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery D18 belongs with facilities". Lena: "Could they call me before four? That's when I need the delivery question answered." Dev: [missing response] Lena: "Please keep before four in the message, even if you can't confirm they'll meet it." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will record a callback request before four. I cannot confirm their availability, so I should not promise that they can meet the requested time.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Lena says: "Use Lena Park, not just Lena. Another person here has called about a different delivery." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 6. It connects Lena's preceding point with Lena's follow-up. Callback request records Lena's wish for a return call without promising the team's response time.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Lena says: "It's delivery D18, not an invoice. I'm trying to reach the facilities team." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Lena says: "Please keep before four in the message, even if you can't confirm they'll meet it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 18

E / Conversation

1. purpose of call

Turn 2. Purpose of call distinguishes the delivery inquiry from an invoice matter before Dev routes it.

2. delivery reference

Turn 4. Delivery reference is D18 and should not be relabeled as an invoice identifier.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. callback request

Turn 6. Callback request records Lena's wish for a return call without promising the team's response time.

4. requested deadline

Turn 8. Requested deadline preserves before four as Lena's timing request, distinct from an accepted commitment.

5. preferred contact route

Turn 10. Preferred contact route is a telephone call, as Lena chooses during the exchange.

6. caller identity

Turn 12. Caller identity is Lena Park, keeping this message distinct from other callers and deliveries.

7. extension

Turn 14. Extension identifies the internal telephone number 214, which Dev corrects without changing the delivery reference.

8. message readback

Turn 16. Message readback combines the caller, intended team, delivery reference, route, and requested deadline for confirmation.

9. handoff note

Turn 18. Handoff note must preserve a facilities delivery inquiry rather than inventing a finance approval request.

10. response commitment

Turn 20. Response commitment would require confirmation from the relevant team, which Dev does not currently have.

Return to the conversation, page 20

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which information still needs verification before the message is usable?

A. The actual contact details for Lena's chosen reply route

A telephone preference alone does not supply a verified callback number; the delivery purpose and facilities route are already established.

Return to the exercise, page 22

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which number should Dev associate with facilities?

C. Extension 214

The brief supplies 214 specifically as the facilities telephone extension.

Return to the exercise, page 22

F / Guided speaking

1. facilities

Assistant: Lena needs the facilities team.

Turn 1. Facilities handles the stated inquiry, not finance or payroll.

2. D18

Caller: The delivery reference is D18.

Turn 2. D18 identifies the delivery discussed in this telephone message.

3. 214

Assistant: The team extension is 214.

Turn 3. 214 is the supplied facilities extension, not the delivery identifier.

4. deadline

Caller: Before 4:00 is my requested deadline.

Turn 4. Deadline preserves the requested timing without asserting that the team has accepted it.

Return to the conversation, page 23

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery D18 belongs with facilities". Lena: "Was the extension two-one-four? I wrote two-four-one and may have reversed the last digits." Dev: [missing response] Lena: "Could you read the message back before we finish? I want to check the team and the delivery reference together." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. It is extension 214, two-one-four. The delivery identifier remains D18. I will keep those two kinds of reference separate in the note.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Lena says: "That's right. There isn't a finance approval or payment question to add." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Lena says: "It's delivery D18, not an invoice. I'm trying to reach the facilities team." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 14. It connects Lena's preceding point with Lena's follow-up. Extension identifies the internal telephone number 214, which Dev corrects without changing the delivery reference.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Lena says: "Please keep before four in the message, even if you can't confirm they'll meet it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 23

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which item does the chair prioritize?

C. Printer replacement

Farah prioritizes the printer item during the final ten minutes.

Return to the exercise, page 26

A2. What can Sam deliver by Thursday?

C. Two quotations

The supplied action is to obtain two quotes by Thursday.

Return to the exercise, page 26

A3. What is the status of signage?

D. To be deferred to the next meeting

Deferral moves the item to a later meeting without resolving its substance.

Return to the exercise, page 26

D / Response choices

D1. Which action record is correct?

A. Sam to obtain two printer quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved

The record names the owner, deliverable, deadline, and purchase-approval limit.

Return to the exercise, page 30

D2. What does deferred mean here?

B. Moved to the next meeting

Deferral postpones discussion without deciding or deleting the item.

Return to the exercise, page 30

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Arrangement of document pages on print sheets so the folded booklet reads in the correct order. Which term fits?

C. booklet imposition

A Not here. deferred item: Topic moved to a later discussion. The usual combination is "retain the deferred item".

B Not here. motion: Formal proposal presented for a meeting's decision where that procedure applies. The usual combination is "distinguish a motion from discussion".

C Correct. booklet imposition: Arrangement of document pages on print sheets so the folded booklet reads in the correct order. The usual combination is "confirm booklet imposition".

D Not here. action point: Agreed task arising from a discussion. The usual combination is "confirm the action point".

Return to the exercise, page 30

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two quotes, not permission to buy". Sam: "Shall I put my name against that action? I don't want the minutes to leave it as someone to get prices." Farah: [missing response] Sam: "I'll keep Thursday as the deadline, then. I haven't offered tomorrow, even though the replacement is becoming urgent." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Yes, you're the action owner, Sam. Please record the two-quote task against your name.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Sam says: "I can get two supplier quotes by Thursday. That will let us compare the offers, but it won't settle which printer to buy." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Farah's response in turn 6. It connects Sam's preceding point with Sam's follow-up. Action owner is Sam, who has offered to obtain the two quotations.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Sam says: "I'll include both outcomes in the summary, so signage doesn't disappear when people only read the action list." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Sam says: "For signage, I'll say next meeting. I haven't got a confirmed date for that meeting to add." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 30

E / Conversation

1. priority item

Turn 2. Priority item is printer replacement, which Farah selects for the remaining meeting time.

2. deliverable

Turn 4. Deliverable is two supplier quotes, not a selected or purchased printer.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. action owner

Turn 6. Action owner is Sam, who has offered to obtain the two quotations.

4. due date

Turn 8. Due date is Thursday, the stated deadline for the two-quote deliverable.

5. purchase approval

Turn 10. Purchase approval has not been given, so obtaining quotations must not be recorded as permission to buy.

6. deferred item

Turn 12. Deferred item keeps visitor signage for the next meeting without treating it as rejected or completed.

7. minutes

Turn 14. Minutes should preserve both the confirmed quote action and the unresolved signage item.

8. action readback

Turn 16. Action readback confirms Sam, two quotations, Thursday, and the absence of purchase approval together.

9. open item

Turn 18. Open item identifies signage as unresolved despite its move to the next meeting.

10. decision log

Turn 20. Decision log records what was actually agreed, including the boundary between preparation and spending authority.

Return to the conversation, page 32

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which question closes the meeting usefully?

C. Can you confirm two quotes by Thursday as my action?

The question verifies the bounded task that Sam can actually carry out.

Return to the exercise, page 34

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which claim exceeds the agreement?

C. A printer order is authorized

The brief explicitly states that no purchase has been approved.

Return to the exercise, page 34

F / Guided speaking

1. Sam

Chair: The action owner is Sam.

Turn 1. Sam is the assistant who offered and accepted the quote-gathering task.

2. quotations

Assistant: I will obtain two quotations.

Turn 2. Quotations are the deliverable, not an approved printer purchase.

3. Thursday

Chair: The due date is Thursday.

Turn 3. Thursday is the explicitly agreed deadline for obtaining the quotes.

4. deferred

Assistant: Visitor signage is deferred to the next meeting.

Turn 4. Deferred postpones discussion without rejecting, approving, or completing the signage item.

Return to the conversation, page 35

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two quotes, not permission to buy". Sam: "I'll include both outcomes in the summary, so signage doesn't disappear when people only read the action list." Farah: [missing response] Sam: "Here's the printer line: Sam to obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved and no supplier selected." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Good. The minutes should distinguish the confirmed printer task from the postponed signage discussion.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Sam says: "I can get two supplier quotes by Thursday. That will let us compare the offers, but it won't settle which printer to buy." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Farah's response in turn 14. It connects Sam's preceding point with Sam's follow-up. Minutes should preserve both the confirmed quote action and the unresolved signage item.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Sam says: "For signage, I'll say next meeting. I haven't got a confirmed date for that meeting to add." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Sam says: "Shall I put my name against that action? I don't want the minutes to leave it as someone to get prices." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 35

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which version is current?

D. Version 3, approved this morning

Version 3 is the approved current guide, despite the earlier email.

Return to the exercise, page 36

A2. What is wrong in version 2?

B. The reception floor

The brief identifies the reception-floor information as the outdated error.

Return to the exercise, page 36

A3. Who should resolve Kai's access?

D. The document owner through the appropriate process

The request belongs with the document owner, not an unauthorized expansion of permissions.

Return to the exercise, page 36

D / Response choices

D1. Which correction is accurate?

D. Use approved version 3; version 2 has the wrong reception floor

The correction identifies the actual current version and the known error.

Return to the exercise, page 40

D2. What permission does Kai need here?

C. Viewing access

The stated problem concerns opening the guide, not editing or unrestricted sharing.

Return to the exercise, page 40

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Document presently valid for the intended purpose. Which term fits?

C. current guide

A Not here. read-only: Allowing viewing without permission to change content. The usual combination is "request read-only access".

B Not here. approval date: Date on which the relevant revision was accepted. The usual combination is "verify the approval date".

C Correct. current guide: Document presently valid for the intended purpose. The usual combination is "link to the current guide".

D Not here. access request: Request for an appropriate permission to be granted. The usual combination is "submit an access request".

Return to the exercise, page 40

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct version, missing permission". Kai: "I tried that link. It says I don't have permission, so I can only open the old attachment." Elena: [missing response] Kai: "Could you just make the link open to anyone? That might be quicker than waiting for the owner." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Then you need viewing access to version 3. I'll ask the document owner to resolve that separately from correcting my earlier message.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Kai says: "While that's pending, should I leave the old attachment in the visitor email as a temporary fallback?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Kai says: "I only need to read it. Please don't ask for editing rights on my behalf." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Kai says: "Could you just make the link open to anyone? That might be quicker than waiting for the owner." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 6. It connects Kai's preceding point with Kai's follow-up. Viewing access is the permission Kai needs to open the approved guide without requesting editing authority.

Return to the exercise, page 40

E / Conversation

1. approved version

Turn 2. Approved version is version 3, accepted this morning and replacing the outdated guide Elena sent.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. current guide

Turn 4. Current guide is the authoritative version 3, which should supply the floor rather than Elena guessing.

3. viewing access

Turn 6. Viewing access is the permission Kai needs to open the approved guide without requesting editing authority.

4. permission scope

Turn 8. Permission scope defines who can access the file, and Elena must not expand it independently.

5. access request

Turn 10. Access request should ask for Kai's viewing permission, not unnecessary editing or public-sharing rights.

6. superseded

Turn 12. Superseded means version 2 has been replaced and should not remain the active source of visitor directions.

7. correction notice

Turn 14. Correction notice explicitly identifies the outdated message and directs recipients to the approved replacement.

8. access error

Turn 16. Access error remains unresolved until the appropriate permission is established and access is confirmed.

9. replacement message

Turn 18. Replacement message corrects the earlier communication while the separate viewing-access request remains visible.

10. document owner

Turn 20. Document owner is the appropriate contact for resolving the requested viewing permission without unauthorized sharing.

Return to the conversation, page 42

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which action exceeds Elena's supplied authority?

A. Making the folder public

Independently widening permissions is explicitly outside the supplied task.

Return to the exercise, page 44

F2. What should Elena avoid claiming?

C. Kai's access is fixed before confirmation

A request for access does not prove that access has been granted or tested.

Return to the exercise, page 44

F / Guided speaking

1. 3

Assistant: The approved guide is version 3.

Turn 1. Version 3 was approved this morning and supersedes the earlier attachment.

2. floor

Recipient: The older version has the wrong reception floor.

Turn 2. Floor is the specific outdated detail identified in the brief.

3. viewing

Assistant: You need viewing access to the current guide.

Turn 3. Viewing allows the required reading without assuming editing or public-sharing rights.

4. owner

Recipient: Please ask the document owner to resolve it.

Turn 4. Owner is the appropriate role for the access request under the supplied instructions.

Return to the conversation, page 45

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct version, missing permission". Kai: "Please make the correction easy to spot. There are several messages in the thread, and a quiet edit would be missed." Elena: [missing response] Kai: "Once you've sent the owner the request, can I tell my colleague the link is fixed?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I'll send a clear correction notice identifying the earlier attachment, the reception-floor error, and version 3 as its replacement.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Kai says: "So one action corrects the information for everyone who received it, and the other resolves my ability to open the right file." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Kai says: "Once you've sent the owner the request, can I tell my colleague the link is fixed?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 14. It connects Kai's preceding point with Kai's follow-up. Correction notice explicitly identifies the outdated message and directs recipients to the approved replacement.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Kai says: "I tried that link. It says I don't have permission, so I can only open the old attachment." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 45

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. How many archive boxes were ordered?

A. Twelve

Purchase order P44 explicitly requests twelve archive boxes.

Return to the exercise, page 48

A2. What quantity was physically checked?

B. Ten boxes

Omar checked the shipment and found ten rather than the twelve listed.

Return to the exercise, page 48

A3. What is documented about a second shipment?

A. Nothing is confirmed

No second package or backorder is documented in the supplied facts.

Return to the exercise, page 48

D / Response choices

D1. Which statement preserves all three quantities?

D. P44 orders twelve, the note lists twelve, and the checked shipment contains ten

The correct statement keeps the order, delivery document, and physical count distinct.

Return to the exercise, page 52

D2. What is the outstanding difference?

B. Two boxes

Twelve ordered minus ten counted leaves two boxes unaccounted for.

Return to the exercise, page 52

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Document listing goods associated with a delivery. Which term fits?

D. delivery note

A Not here. backorder: Order quantity awaiting later fulfillment. The usual combination is "verify a documented backorder".

B Not here. receipt record: Account of goods actually received. The usual combination is "preserve the receipt record".

C Not here. payment approval: Authorization to pay the relevant charge. The usual combination is "keep payment approval separate".

D Correct. delivery note: Document listing goods associated with a delivery. The usual combination is "compare the delivery note".

Return to the exercise, page 52

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment". Omar: "There isn't a second package or backorder recorded here. Has something been sent separately?" Leila: [missing response] Omar: "Please confirm the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. I need both points answered." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Understood. A split shipment has not been documented in the information you have. I need to check rather than tell you another package is already on its way.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Omar says: "Please come back with the quantity and shipment position, not just an acknowledgment that you received the query." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Omar says: "Please confirm the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. I need both points answered." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Leila's response in turn 6. It connects Omar's preceding point with Omar's follow-up. Split shipment would mean more than one consignment, but no such arrangement is documented here.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Omar says: "Should I leave the receiving record at ten while you check? Someone suggested matching it to the delivery note." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 52

E / Conversation

1. ordered quantity

Turn 2. Ordered quantity is twelve archive boxes, the amount specified on purchase order P44.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. quantity discrepancy

Turn 4. Quantity discrepancy is the difference between twelve ordered and documented and ten physically checked.

3. split shipment

Turn 6. Split shipment would mean more than one consignment, but no such arrangement is documented here.

4. outstanding quantity

Turn 8. Outstanding quantity is the two ordered boxes not yet accounted for in the checked receipt.

5. order reference

Turn 10. Order reference P44 links the archive-box discrepancy to the correct supply transaction.

6. checked count

Turn 12. Checked count is ten, and it must not be changed merely to match the delivery paperwork.

7. supplier query

Turn 14. Supplier query requests clarification of the missing supply facts without accusing anyone of wrongdoing.

8. dispatch record

Turn 16. Dispatch record may clarify what was sent, but its contents have not yet been confirmed in the conversation.

9. Payment approval

Turn 18. Payment approval is separate from the supply query and has not been given by Omar.

10. supplier response

Turn 20. Supplier response should address both the outstanding two boxes and the unconfirmed further-shipment position.

Return to the conversation, page 54

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which question is justified?

C. Is another shipment planned for the outstanding two?

The question seeks missing supply information without inventing a cause or status.

Return to the exercise, page 56

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which record should remain accurate?

D. The checked receipt of ten

The receipt record must preserve the actual checked quantity despite the document discrepancy.

Return to the exercise, page 56

F / Guided speaking

1. P44

Assistant: The purchase order is P44.

Turn 1. P44 identifies the archive-box order being queried with the supplier.

2. twelve

Supplier: The order and delivery note both list twelve boxes.

Turn 2. Twelve is the documented ordered quantity and delivery-note quantity.

3. ten

Assistant: The checked shipment contains ten boxes.

Turn 3. Ten is the actual checked receipt and must remain distinct from the paperwork.

4. two

Supplier: The outstanding difference is two boxes.

Turn 4. Two is the difference between twelve ordered and ten physically checked.

Return to the conversation, page 57

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment". Omar: "I want to report the difference without blaming the driver. We don't know why it happened." Leila: [missing response] Omar: "Could you compare the dispatch record with P44? I don't want to assume the missing two were held back." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Agreed. The supplier query can ask for confirmation without alleging theft or blaming a particular person. The current evidence does not establish a cause.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Omar says: "Could you check P44, our archive-box order? The quantity on the paperwork doesn't match what we received." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Leila's response in turn 14. It connects Omar's preceding point with Omar's follow-up. Supplier query requests clarification of the missing supply facts without accusing anyone of wrongdoing.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Omar says: "We ordered twelve. The note says twelve too, but I've checked the shipment and counted ten." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Omar says: "And this query isn't payment approval or permission to close the discrepancy." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 57

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which Jordan is named on V12?

C. Jordan Chen in facilities

The visitor reference explicitly identifies Jordan Chen in facilities.

Return to the exercise, page 58

A2. Where should Taylor wait?

C. At reception

Taylor has not been cleared to enter other areas alone.

Return to the exercise, page 58

A3. What is not confirmed?

C. When the host will reach reception

No host arrival time is provided in the supplied information.

Return to the exercise, page 58

D / Response choices

D1. Which host message is accurate?

D. Taylor is at reception for V12 with Jordan Chen at 10:00

The message retains the visitor, reference, host, time, and current waiting location.

Return to the exercise, page 62

D2. Which sentence is courteous and accurate?

B. Please wait at reception while I contact Jordan Chen

The instruction states the supplied waiting arrangement without inventing timing or access.

Return to the exercise, page 62

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Information describing a scheduled visit or meeting. Which term fits?

D. appointment record

A Not here. escort: Authorized person accompanying a visitor where required. The usual combination is "confirm the escort arrangement".

B Not here. arrival: Visitor's appearance at the location. The usual combination is "acknowledge the arrival".

C Not here. reception wait: Period spent at reception pending the next arrangement. The usual combination is "explain the reception wait".

D Correct. appointment record: Information describing a scheduled visit or meeting. The usual combination is "check the appointment record".

Return to the exercise, page 62

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two Jordans, one visitor reference". Taylor: "Yes, Jordan Chen is right. I might have ended up in sales if you hadn't checked." Nia: [missing response] Taylor: "Do you know if Jordan's already coming down? The meeting is at ten." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will send the host notification to Jordan Chen, using V12 and your name. Please wait here at reception while I make contact.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Taylor says: "Could you repeat the full name and department once? I'd like to use the right surname." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 6. It connects Taylor's preceding point with Taylor's follow-up. Host notification tells Jordan Chen that Taylor has arrived and is waiting at reception.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Taylor says: "Good morning, Taylor here for a ten o'clock meeting with Jordan. I've got the confirmation on my phone." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Taylor says: "It's V12. I remembered Jordan's first name but not the surname." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 62

E / Conversation

1. visitor reference

Turn 2. Visitor reference V12 identifies the intended arrangement and resolves which Jordan is the host.

2. appointment record

Turn 4. Appointment record for V12 names Jordan Chen in facilities for the scheduled ten o'clock meeting.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. host notification

Turn 6. Host notification tells Jordan Chen that Taylor has arrived and is waiting at reception.

4. host availability

Turn 8. Host availability is not established merely because the appointment is scheduled for ten.

5. waiting area

Turn 10. Waiting area is reception, where Taylor should remain pending the next arrangement.

6. unaccompanied access

Turn 12. Unaccompanied access is separate from the meeting reference and has not been granted to Taylor.

7. arrival

Turn 14. Arrival is the fact that Taylor is presently at reception, not merely a future appointment inquiry.

8. reception wait

Turn 16. Reception wait is the agreed current arrangement, without inventing another room or host arrival estimate.

9. surname

Turn 18. Surname Chen distinguishes the intended host from Jordan Patel in sales.

10. visitor handoff

Turn 20. Visitor handoff concerns the next confirmed reception arrangement rather than an assumed right to enter alone.

Return to the conversation, page 64

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What resolves the first-name ambiguity?

A. V12 and the full host name

The appointment reference identifies the specific Jordan intended for this visit.

Return to the exercise, page 66

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which fact must remain separate from the booking?

C. Permission to enter other areas alone

A meeting arrangement does not itself establish the supplied unaccompanied-access permission.

Return to the exercise, page 66

F / Guided speaking

1. V12

Receptionist: The visitor reference is V12.

Turn 1. V12 identifies Taylor's meeting arrangement with the intended host.

2. Chen

Visitor: I am meeting Jordan Chen.

Turn 2. Chen distinguishes the facilities host from Jordan Patel in sales.

3. facilities

Receptionist: Your host works in facilities.

Turn 3. Facilities is the department associated with Jordan Chen in the supplied record.

4. reception

Visitor: I will wait at reception.

Turn 4. Reception is the stated waiting location until the next arrangement is confirmed.

Return to the conversation, page 67

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two Jordans, one visitor reference". Taylor: "Please tell Jordan I've arrived, rather than just asking whether the meeting's still on." Nia: [missing response] Taylor: "Reception is fine. I don't need a different room; I just need Jordan to know where I am." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Certainly. The arrival message will say Taylor is at reception for the ten o'clock meeting, reference V12. It will not describe this as a new booking request.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Taylor says: "Reception is fine. I don't need a different room; I just need Jordan to know where I am." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Taylor says: "Understood. I thought the meeting confirmation might be enough to go through." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Taylor says: "Do you know if Jordan's already coming down? The meeting is at ten." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 14. It connects Taylor's preceding point with Taylor's follow-up. Arrival is the fact that Taylor is presently at reception, not merely a future appointment inquiry.

Return to the exercise, page 67

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is the price difference between the quotes?

A. $20

Option B costs $90 and option A costs $70, so the difference is $20.

Return to the exercise, page 70

A2. Under the supplied terms, what refund does B permit before departure?

C. $80

The $90 fare less the stated $10 deduction leaves an $80 refund before departure.

Return to the exercise, page 70

A3. What must happen before purchase?

A. Obtain the required purchasing approval

Purchasing approval is explicitly still required before the assistant can book.

Return to the exercise, page 70

D / Response choices

D1. Which comparison is complete?

D. A is $70 nonrefundable; B is $90 with an $80 refund before departure

The comparison retains both prices and B's conditional refund after the deduction.

Return to the exercise, page 75

D2. What does the $10 represent?

B. The deduction from B's refund

The supplied $10 is subtracted from B's $90 refund, not from the price comparison.

Return to the exercise, page 75

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Permitting a refund subject to the applicable conditions. Which term fits?

C. refundable

A Not here. price difference: Amount by which one price exceeds another. The usual combination is "state the price difference".

B Not here. travel authorization: Approval for travel within a defined scope. The usual combination is "distinguish travel authorization".

C Correct. refundable: Permitting a refund subject to the applicable conditions. The usual combination is "qualify refundable".

D Not here. cash advance: Money provided before eligible expenses are settled, to be reconciled against the applicable claim. The usual combination is "reconcile the cash advance".

Return to the exercise, page 75

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher fare with a conditional refund". Mira: "For B, how much would actually come back? Refundable sounds like ninety, but there's a deduction." Ben: [missing response] Mira: "I nearly treated the ten dollars as the price difference. That's the amount retained from a refund, isn't it?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The net refund would be eighty dollars: ninety less ten. We should state the condition and the deduction together rather than simply describe B as refundable.

A Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 6. It connects Mira's preceding point with Mira's follow-up. Net refund is eighty dollars after subtracting the stated ten-dollar deduction from B's ninety-dollar fare.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Mira says: "I nearly treated the ten dollars as the price difference. That's the amount retained from a refund, isn't it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Mira says: "So B costs twenty more to buy, while the refund deduction is ten. Those aren't the same comparison." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Mira says: "Please keep this as a comparison. Asking about refunds isn't an instruction to buy a ticket." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 75

E / Conversation

1. fare

Turn 2. Fare is the upfront travel price: seventy dollars for A and ninety dollars for B.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. nonrefundable

Turn 4. Nonrefundable describes option A under the supplied quoted terms without inventing additional exceptions.

3. net refund

Turn 6. Net refund is eighty dollars after subtracting the stated ten-dollar deduction from B's ninety-dollar fare.

4. upfront cost

Turn 8. Upfront cost is the purchase price, separate from the amount retained if a conditional refund occurs.

5. price difference

Turn 10. Price difference is twenty dollars because the quoted fares are ninety and seventy dollars.

6. before departure

Turn 12. Before departure is the stated refund condition, and no after-departure permission is supplied.

7. booking status

Turn 14. Booking status remains unapproved because a comparison and questions do not authorize a purchase.

8. conditional comparison

Turn 16. Conditional comparison presents the two prices and B's limited refund without choosing or booking for Mira.

9. unconfirmed meeting

Turn 18. Unconfirmed meeting describes the unresolved travel purpose without converting it into a recommendation or cancellation.

10. Purchasing approval

Turn 20. Purchasing approval is the missing authorization required before Ben can turn the comparison into a booking.

Return to the conversation, page 77

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which claim is unsupported?

B. B is refundable after departure without restrictions

The supplied terms establish a before-departure refund only, with no later rule provided.

Return to the exercise, page 79

F2. Which handoff is ready for the approver?

B. Both quotes with conditions, meeting unconfirmed, no purchase approved

A comparison can be passed for decision without selecting a fare, issuing a ticket, or extending the supplied refund terms.

Return to the exercise, page 79

F / Guided speaking

1. seventy

Assistant: Option A costs seventy dollars.

Turn 1. Seventy is the nonrefundable option's stated upfront price.

2. ninety

Traveler: Option B costs ninety dollars.

Turn 2. Ninety is B's purchase price before any later conditional refund.

3. eighty

Assistant: Before departure, B permits an eighty-dollar refund.

Turn 3. Eighty is ninety minus the stated ten-dollar refund deduction.

4. approval

Traveler: Purchasing approval is still required.

Turn 4. Approval remains necessary because discussing the alternatives does not authorize a ticket purchase.

Return to the conversation, page 80

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher fare with a conditional refund". Mira: "Please keep this as a comparison. Asking about refunds isn't an instruction to buy a ticket." Ben: [missing response] Mira: "Can you give me a short summary for the approver without saying I've selected one?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will keep the booking status clear. This is a comparison, not a reservation or ticket purchase, and purchasing approval is still required before any commitment.

A Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 14. It connects Mira's preceding point with Mira's follow-up. Booking status remains unapproved because a comparison and questions do not authorize a purchase.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Mira says: "I nearly treated the ten dollars as the price difference. That's the amount retained from a refund, isn't it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Mira says: "For B, how much would actually come back? Refundable sounds like ninety, but there's a deduction." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Mira says: "So B costs twenty more to buy, while the refund deduction is ten. Those aren't the same comparison." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 80

08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is due at 10:30?

A. The visitor list

The visitor list has the earliest of the two original deadlines.

Return to the exercise, page 81

A2. How much work is requested in total?

D. Eighty minutes

Two thirty-minute tasks plus a twenty-minute check total eighty minutes.

Return to the exercise, page 81

A3. What should Rosa ask Ellis to do?

B. Choose priorities or adjust a deadline

The supplied capacity conflict requires a decision about priorities or timing.

Return to the exercise, page 81

D / Response choices

D1. If Rosa does the check first, when can the visitor list finish at the earliest?

B. 10:50

Twenty minutes for the check plus thirty for the list gives a 10:50 finish.

Return to the exercise, page 85

D2. If that sequence continues with the room pack, when does it finish?

A. 11:20

The check and two thirty-minute tasks require eighty minutes from 10:00.

Return to the exercise, page 85

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Latest required completion time for a task. Which term fits?

C. deadline

A Not here. existing obligation: Task already required before the new request arrives. The usual combination is "preserve existing obligations".

B Not here. coverage: Availability of another person to handle work during the relevant period. The usual combination is "confirm coverage".

C Correct. deadline: Latest required completion time for a task. The usual combination is "clarify the deadline".

D Not here. competing request: New demand that conflicts with existing commitments. The usual combination is "identify the competing request".

Return to the exercise, page 85

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window". Ellis: "If you start the spreadsheet right away, it finishes at ten twenty. Where does that leave the list?" Rosa: [missing response] Ellis: "Could you do the list faster to catch up? I'm trying to avoid moving the visitor deadline." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. It uses twenty minutes of the time window. With the list next, its earliest finish becomes ten fifty, not ten thirty.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Ellis says: "Then the room pack would follow the list and finish at eleven twenty. That's late as well." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 6. It connects Ellis's preceding point with Ellis's follow-up. Time window from 10:00 to 11:00 contains sixty minutes, less than the eighty minutes of requested work.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Ellis says: "Let me check which deadline has flexibility before answering. I don't want you to drop the list without me realizing." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Ellis says: "Could you do the list faster to catch up? I'm trying to avoid moving the visitor deadline." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 85

E / Conversation

1. competing request

Turn 2. Competing request is the new twenty-minute spreadsheet check that conflicts with Rosa's existing commitments.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. visitor list

Turn 4. Visitor list is due at 10:30 and requires thirty minutes, so it occupies the first available half hour.

3. time window

Turn 6. Time window from 10:00 to 11:00 contains sixty minutes, less than the eighty minutes of requested work.

4. task duration

Turn 8. Task duration is thirty minutes for each existing task and cannot be silently reduced to make the schedule fit.

5. schedule impact

Turn 10. Schedule impact is a 10:50 list finish followed by an 11:20 room-pack finish if the spreadsheet goes first.

6. coverage

Turn 12. Coverage would require another available person, which the supplied situation explicitly lacks.

7. priority decision

Turn 14. Priority decision determines which task takes precedence and which existing commitment must change.

8. revised deadline

Turn 16. Revised deadline must be explicitly agreed rather than inferred from Rosa's explanation of the conflict.

9. overcommitment

Turn 18. Overcommitment would be promising all three original deadlines despite eighty minutes of work in the available hour.

10. decision readback

Turn 20. Decision readback follows an actual priority decision; no revised sequence or deadline is approved yet.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which response is professionally clear?

A. I need a priority choice or an adjusted deadline because these tasks require eighty minutes

The response states the capacity conflict and asks the manager for an explicit decision.

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F2. What remains unresolved at the end of the case?

C. Which priority or deadline Ellis will change

The case supplies the conflict but does not provide Ellis's final priority decision.

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F / Guided speaking

1. eighty

Assistant: The three tasks require eighty minutes in total.

Turn 1. Eighty combines the two thirty-minute tasks and the new twenty-minute check.

2. 10:30

Manager: The visitor list is originally due at 10:30.

Turn 2. 10:30 remains the original deadline until a change is explicitly agreed.

3. 10:50

Assistant: If the check comes first, the list finishes no earlier than 10:50.

Turn 3. 10:50 follows twenty minutes for the check and thirty for the visitor list.

4. decision

Manager: A priority decision is still needed.

Turn 4. Decision remains outstanding because no changed priority or deadline has been approved.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window". Ellis: "All three feel urgent, but I see that saying urgent doesn't create another twenty minutes." Rosa: [missing response] Ellis: "Let me check which deadline has flexibility before answering. I don't want you to drop the list without me realizing." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I need a priority decision. Should the spreadsheet come first, and if so, which existing commitment may move?

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Ellis says: "Then the room pack would follow the list and finish at eleven twenty. That's late as well." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Ellis says: "Could you do the list faster to catch up? I'm trying to avoid moving the visitor deadline." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 14. It connects Ellis's preceding point with Ellis's follow-up. Priority decision determines which task takes precedence and which existing commitment must change.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Ellis says: "Don't treat the new request as fully accepted yet. I still need to choose what changes." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Location or standard that gives a clock time meaning. Which term fits?

B. time reference

A Not here. organizer: Person responsible for arranging the meeting. The usual combination is "identify the organizer".

B Correct. time reference: Location or standard that gives a clock time meaning. The usual combination is "clarify the time reference".

C Not here. acceptance: Response agreeing to the stated invitation. The usual combination is "confirm acceptance".

D Not here. offset: Difference between one time reference and another. The usual combination is "verify the relevant offset".

Return to the exercise, page 24

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Written record of a call for another person. Which term fits?

C. message slip

A Not here. misdirected call: Call sent to a recipient who does not handle its purpose. The usual combination is "prevent a misdirected call".

B Not here. call routing: Directing a telephone inquiry to the appropriate recipient. The usual combination is "confirm call routing".

C Correct. message slip: Written record of a call for another person. The usual combination is "complete the message slip".

D Not here. transfer: Connection of an existing call to another line. The usual combination is "distinguish a transfer from a callback".

Return to the exercise, page 24

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Three o'clock in whose office?". Maya: "I'll send those separately. For now, can you keep the intended time without filling in an hour by default?" Arun: [missing response] Maya: "We may need another meeting with them later. Can I just use the same three-hour difference every time?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Yes. I'll retain the meeting request as three here and noon there on this date, with those other details outstanding.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Maya says: "Three here. I was looking at my own calendar and forgot that the other office would see a different time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Maya says: "Yes, three here and noon there. Please don't put three next to both office names in the message." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Arun's response in turn 10. It connects Maya's preceding point with Maya's follow-up. Meeting request remains a proposal whose details must be confirmed before an invitation is issued.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Maya says: "Could you set up three o'clock with the other office? Both calendars look open, so I'd like to get it arranged." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery D18 belongs with facilities". Lena: "That's right. There isn't a finance approval or payment question to add." Dev: [missing response] Lena: "Thank you. I understand you're passing on a request, not guaranteeing their response." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Agreed. The handoff note will contain no payment or finance-approval request. Its purpose is to get the delivery question to the appropriate facilities colleagues.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Lena says: "Please keep before four in the message, even if you can't confirm they'll meet it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 18. It connects Lena's preceding point with Lena's follow-up. Handoff note must preserve a facilities delivery inquiry rather than inventing a finance approval request.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Lena says: "It's delivery D18, not an invoice. I'm trying to reach the facilities team." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Lena says: "Could they call me before four? That's when I need the delivery question answered." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Person directing the meeting. Which term fits?

D. chair

A Not here. decision log: Record of decisions and their scope. The usual combination is "update the decision log".

B Not here. purchase approval: Permission to buy the specified item. The usual combination is "distinguish purchase approval".

C Not here. budget authority: Permission to commit funds within an identified scope. The usual combination is "confirm budget authority".

D Correct. chair: Person directing the meeting. The usual combination is "ask the chair to confirm".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Authority to modify the content. Which term fits?

D. editing permission

A Not here. distribution list: Set of recipients for a message or document. The usual combination is "check the distribution list".

B Not here. document link: Address pointing to a stored file. The usual combination is "share the current document link".

C Not here. document version: Identified revision of a file or publication. The usual combination is "check the document version".

D Correct. editing permission: Authority to modify the content. The usual combination is "distinguish editing permission".

Return to the exercise, page 46

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery D18 belongs with facilities". Lena: "A telephone call, please. I'll confirm the contact number with you." Dev: [missing response] Lena: "Use Lena Park, not just Lena. Another person here has called about a different delivery." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I will note the preferred contact route as telephone and verify the relevant details with you. I will not substitute email just because it is easier to forward.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Lena says: "Hello, Lena Park here. I was sent to finance about D18, but I think I need facilities." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Lena says: "Use Lena Park, not just Lena. Another person here has called about a different delivery." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 10. It connects Lena's preceding point with Lena's follow-up. Preferred contact route is a telephone call, as Lena chooses during the exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Lena says: "Could they call me before four? That's when I need the delivery question answered." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 46

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct version, missing permission". Kai: "So one action corrects the information for everyone who received it, and the other resolves my ability to open the right file." Elena: [missing response] Kai: "Thank you. I won't forward version 2 or say I can open version 3 until it's working." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Exactly. The replacement message will correct the reference, while the access request stays visible as a separate follow-up.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Kai says: "Once you've sent the owner the request, can I tell my colleague the link is fixed?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Kai says: "I tried that link. It says I don't have permission, so I can only open the old attachment." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 18. It connects Kai's preceding point with Kai's follow-up. Replacement message corrects the earlier communication while the separate viewing-access request remains visible.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Kai says: "Please make the correction easy to spot. There are several messages in the thread, and a quiet edit would be missed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 46

Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Number of units requested on the order. Which term fits?

D. ordered quantity

A Not here. outstanding quantity: Ordered amount not yet accounted for as received. The usual combination is "confirm the outstanding quantity".

B Not here. order reference: Identifier connecting an inquiry to the correct order. The usual combination is "include the order reference".

C Not here. partial receipt: Receipt of only part of the ordered amount. The usual combination is "record a partial receipt".

D Correct. ordered quantity: Number of units requested on the order. The usual combination is "verify the ordered quantity".

Return to the exercise, page 68

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Time recorded for the arranged meeting. Which term fits?

C. scheduled time

A Not here. identity match: Agreement between the person or name and the relevant record. The usual combination is "verify the identity match".

B Not here. reception: Area where visitors first report and are assisted. The usual combination is "wait at reception".

C Correct. scheduled time: Time recorded for the arranged meeting. The usual combination is "confirm the scheduled time".

D Not here. access clearance: Confirmed permission to enter a defined area. The usual combination is "verify access clearance".

Return to the exercise, page 68

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct version, missing permission". Kai: "I only need to read it. Please don't ask for editing rights on my behalf." Elena: [missing response] Kai: "While that's pending, should I leave the old attachment in the visitor email as a temporary fallback?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I'll make the access request specific: Kai needs to view the approved visitor guide, version 3, and the current link returns an error.

A Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 10. It connects Kai's preceding point with Kai's follow-up. Access request should ask for Kai's viewing permission, not unnecessary editing or public-sharing rights.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Kai says: "I tried that link. It says I don't have permission, so I can only open the old attachment." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Kai says: "Can you tell me the correct floor now? I don't want to forward two different sets of directions." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Kai says: "Could you just make the link open to anyone? That might be quicker than waiting for the owner." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two Jordans, one visitor reference". Taylor: "Could you repeat the full name and department once? I'd like to use the right surname." Nia: [missing response] Taylor: "Thank you. I'll stay here for the next update." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Jordan Chen in facilities. Confirming the surname prevents confusion with Jordan Patel in sales. Your reference is V12, and you are waiting here at reception.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Taylor says: "Good morning, Taylor here for a ten o'clock meeting with Jordan. I've got the confirmation on my phone." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Taylor says: "Do you know if Jordan's already coming down? The meeting is at ten." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Taylor says: "It's V12. I remembered Jordan's first name but not the surname." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 18. It connects Taylor's preceding point with Taylor's follow-up. Surname Chen distinguishes the intended host from Jordan Patel in sales.

Return to the exercise, page 68

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Not permitting a refund under the stated quoted terms. Which term fits?

A. nonrefundable

A Correct. nonrefundable: Not permitting a refund under the stated quoted terms. The usual combination is "identify a nonrefundable fare".

B Not here. itinerary: Planned sequence and details of travel. The usual combination is "check the itinerary".

C Not here. net refund: Amount returned after the stated deduction. The usual combination is "calculate the net refund".

D Not here. upfront cost: Amount paid at the time of purchase. The usual combination is "compare upfront costs".

Return to the exercise, page 91

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Review of the specified spreadsheet information. Which term fits?

C. spreadsheet check

A Not here. schedule impact: Effect of a change on task timing. The usual combination is "explain the schedule impact".

B Not here. workload: Amount of work assigned or awaiting completion. The usual combination is "explain the workload".

C Correct. spreadsheet check: Review of the specified spreadsheet information. The usual combination is "perform the spreadsheet check".

D Not here. revised deadline: Newly agreed completion requirement. The usual combination is "obtain a revised deadline".

Return to the exercise, page 91

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Two Jordans, one visitor reference". Taylor: "Could I wait near the facilities office instead, so I'm easier to find?" Nia: [missing response] Taylor: "Understood. I thought the meeting confirmation might be enough to go through." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Please remain in the waiting area here for now. You have not been cleared to enter the other areas alone, and I do not want to send you beyond the current arrangement.

A Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 10. It connects Taylor's preceding point with Taylor's follow-up. Waiting area is reception, where Taylor should remain pending the next arrangement.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Taylor says: "Thank you. I'll stay here for the next update." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Taylor says: "Reception is fine. I don't need a different room; I just need Jordan to know where I am." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Taylor says: "Please tell Jordan I've arrived, rather than just asking whether the meeting's still on." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 91

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window". Ellis: "Don't treat the new request as fully accepted yet. I still need to choose what changes." Rosa: [missing response] Ellis: "Keep the durations and consequences in front of us. I'll use those to make the choice." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Understood. That avoids overcommitment: eighty minutes of work can't fit into the available sixty while preserving these original deadlines.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Ellis says: "Could you do the list faster to catch up? I'm trying to avoid moving the visitor deadline." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Ellis says: "Then the room pack would follow the list and finish at eleven twenty. That's late as well." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Ellis says: "All three feel urgent, but I see that saying urgent doesn't create another twenty minutes." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 18. It connects Ellis's preceding point with Ellis's follow-up. Overcommitment would be promising all three original deadlines despite eighty minutes of work in the available hour.

Return to the exercise, page 91

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. payment method

Turn 2. The hotel was paid directly by the company, while the meal and rail fare were employee-paid; adding all receipts does not give the amount owed to Mira.

2. company-paid expense

Turn 4. The hotel remains a documented trip cost but is excluded from employee reimbursement because the company has already paid it directly.

3. itemization

Turn 6. Itemization separates the meal receipt's forty-eight-dollar eligible share from its twenty-dollar personal share; the whole sixty-eight is not reimbursable in this case.

4. out-of-pocket expenses

Turn 8. The eligible employee-paid amounts are forty-eight for the meal and forty-two for rail, totaling ninety; the company-paid hotel is not added.

5. cash advance

Turn 10. The fifty-dollar advance is money already provided for the trip; subtract it once from ninety dollars of eligible employee-paid costs to obtain forty due.

6. net reimbursement

Turn 12. Ninety eligible employee-paid dollars less the fifty-dollar advance leaves forty dollars due to the employee, subject to the pending approval and payment.

Return to the conversation, page 94

Transfer exchange

1. 120

Traveler: Eligible employee-paid costs are 120 dollars.

Turn 1. The case explicitly supplies one hundred twenty as eligible; the separate personal and company-paid amounts are not added.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. 80

Assistant: The advance to subtract once is 80 dollars.

Turn 2. Eighty has already been provided to the employee and offsets the eligible employee-paid total.

3. 40

Traveler: The calculated amount due to me is 40 dollars.

Turn 3. One hundred twenty minus eighty equals forty; the personal fifteen and company-paid two hundred do not enter this reimbursement.

4. pending

Assistant: The approval status is still pending .

Turn 4. Reconciling the amounts does not establish approval or payment of the claim.

Return to the conversation, page 97

Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. recipient identifier

Turn 2. The supplied IDs distinguish people; the owner confirms that the repeated A02 row is an identical duplicate, leaving five distinct people in six rows.

2. duplicate record

Turn 4. A02 and A03 are different people sharing an address; only the repeated A02 row is confirmed as an identical duplicate in this case.

3. recipient filter

Turn 6. The confirmed-only selection includes A01, A02, and A03 once each; declined A04 and pending A05 are excluded from this particular mailing.

4. data source

Turn 8. The underlying contact data remains distinct from the subset selected for this mailing; excluding someone from the current run does not require deleting their source record.

5. leading zeros

Turn 10. The verified test code is 00123; dropping its leading zeros changes the identifier, and the prepared text value must retain all five characters.

6. merge field

Turn 12. A merge field inserts a particular source value into the template; the name, address, and code must all come from the intended recipient's record.

Return to the conversation, page 99

Transfer exchange

1. two

Assistant: The selected mailing should contain two letters.

Turn 1. Only confirmed B01 and B03 qualify; the duplicate pending B02 does not add an eligible recipient.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. pending

Owner: B02 remains pending, not confirmed.

Turn 2. Its supplied response status stays pending even though the duplicate row must be resolved.

3. 00456

Assistant: B01's code must read 00456 in the output.

Turn 3. The verified source contains both leading zeros; the preview's 456 has lost part of the identifier.

4. unconfirmed

Owner: Dispatch is unconfirmed .

Turn 4. A selected list and corrected preview do not establish that letters have been dispatched.

Return to the conversation, page 102

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. booklet imposition

Turn 2. Booklet imposition arranges the document pages for folding; this brief puts four finished pages on each physical A3 sheet, not one page per sheet.

2. Duplex printing

Turn 4. Duplex means both sides are printed; the supplied two-pages-per-side layout gives four document pages across a physical sheet, not eight.

3. sheet count

Turn 6. Thirty finished booklets at five physical sheets each require one hundred fifty A3 sheets; duplex use is already included in the four-pages-per-sheet calculation.

4. finished size

Turn 8. The booklet's finished page size is A4 after the A3 sheets are folded; A3 is the input sheet size, not the finished booklet-page size.

5. physical proof

Turn 10. A complete physical proof uses all five sheets of the twenty-page booklet; two separate proofs therefore need ten sheets, not two.

6. production quantity

Turn 12. The order requires thirty finished distribution copies in addition to two proofs; the proofs must not reduce the thirty-copy delivery quantity.

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Transfer exchange

1. six

Coordinator: Each booklet requires six sheets.

Turn 1. Twenty-four finished pages divided by four pages per sheet gives six physical sheets.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. 108

Print lead: The eighteen distribution copies use 108 sheets.

Turn 2. Eighteen multiplied by six equals one hundred eight sheets, before the separate proof.

3. 114

Coordinator: Including the complete proof, exact usage is 114 sheets.

Turn 3. The six-sheet proof is additional to the one hundred eight sheets for distribution, totaling one hundred fourteen.

4. pending

Print lead: Full production remains pending .

Turn 4. The brief requires proof approval, which has not occurred; a paper calculation does not release production.

Return to the conversation, page 107

Find a phrase by purpose

Scheduling across calendars and time zones

Clarify the reference: Do you mean 3:00 in your office or the other office?

Explain the equivalence: On this date, your 3:00 is their noon.

Keep the question neutral: I want to make sure both offices receive the same meeting time.

Full phrase bank, page 7

Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

Clarify the purpose: Is this about the delivery or an invoice?

Identify the team: You need facilities rather than finance.

Ask for the reference: Could you confirm the delivery reference?

Full phrase bank, page 17

Preparing meetings and confirming action points

Signal the time: We have ten minutes left.

Name the competing items: Printer replacement and visitor signage are still on the agenda.

Ask for direction: Which item should take priority?

Full phrase bank, page 29

Checking document versions and access

Own the error: I sent version 2 in my earlier message.

Name the replacement: Version 3 was approved this morning.

Identify the affected detail: The older guide gives the wrong reception floor.

Full phrase bank, page 39

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Querying office supplies and delivery differences

Identify the order: I am calling about purchase order P44.

State the ordered amount: The order is for twelve archive boxes.

State the document amount: The delivery note also lists twelve.

Full phrase bank, page 51

Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

Open warmly: Good morning. Who are you here to see?

Acknowledge the booking: You have a 10:00 meeting with Jordan.

Explain the ambiguity: We have two colleagues called Jordan.

Full phrase bank, page 61

Clarifying travel options and booking status

Define the comparison: Both quotes cover the same trip.

State option A: A costs $70 and is nonrefundable.

State option B: B costs $90.

Full phrase bank, page 74

Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

Acknowledge the request: I understand you need the spreadsheet check by 10:20.

Name the existing work: The visitor list and room pack are already due this morning.

State the first deadline: The visitor list is due at 10:30.

Full phrase bank, page 84

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References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Secretaries and Administrative Assistants.

Occupational context for scheduling, documents, calls, records, and administrative coordination. The teaching cases are original and fictional. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.bls.gov/ooh/office-and-administrative-support/secretaries-and-administrative-assistants.htm

[2] Google Calendar Help. Use Google Calendar in Different Time Zones.

Background for distinguishing a meeting instant from local clock displays. The fictional case supplies its own date-specific equivalence. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://support.google.com/calendar/answer/37064

[3] Microsoft Support. Sharing Files, Folders, and List Items.

Terminology for document links, viewing access, and permissions. The book does not instruct learners to change workplace access rights. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/sharepoint/libraries/sharing-files-folders-and-list-items

> **Companion course**
>
> The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.
>
> https://englishladder.com/efsp-office-administrative-assistants.html

Clear arrangements. Reliable follow-through.

Eight everyday office situations demand precise English: cross-office scheduling, call messages, meeting actions, document corrections, delivery queries, visitor reception, travel comparisons, and deadline negotiations.

Scheduling across calendars and time zones

The supplied equivalence is 3:00 in Maya's office and noon in the other office on the fictional date. Do not put 3:00 on both local displays or assume the same difference applies on every date.

Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

The reference is delivery D18, and the team is facilities at extension 214. Do not turn the call into an invoice query for finance. A good message retains the name, purpose, reference, contact route, and requested deadline.

Preparing meetings and confirming action points

Sam is the action owner. The deliverable is two quotes, due Thursday. No purchase has been approved. Obtaining prices and terms prepares a later decision; it does not establish supplier selection, an order, or installation.

Checking document versions and access

Version 3 was approved this morning. Version 2 contains the wrong reception floor and should not remain the active guide. The brief does not supply the correct floor number, so the correction must point to the current guide rather than invent directions.

Phil Stilwell

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